

Aging Parents: the parent's point of view — research summary

Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-parents/research/> · researched 2026-09-13 · refresh due 2027-03-13

TLDR

- Who: older adults, median age 72 among the 2,407 who state it, most in their late 60s to late 70s. 366 write as widows or widowers and 213 say outright that they live alone.
- What they fear, in their own words: the money running out (26), ending up in a nursing home (20), becoming a burden to their children (18) and a painful, drawn-out end (17). Falling with no one to help (11) and dying alone, found days later (6) are fewer but the most vivid.
- What they resist: leaving home (51 say they are staying put) and facilities (22 refuse in their own words, 52 more as their children quote them). Refusing aides, bathing help and hearing aids is visible mostly through their children's quotes (30, 23 and 20).
- Why they resist: 'I'm fine / not yet', independence, not wanting to be a burden, their home and memories, and wanting to die at home; with hearing aids and facilities, not wanting to look or live 'old'. A smaller group pre-consents instead: 'put me in a home if I get dementia' (14), to spare their children.
- What they need help with is getting around: walking (52), driving and rides (55), stairs and getting up (21), meals (21) and help if they fall (17). The paid help they already describe is housework and the yard (55 people), not personal care.
- Decision: keep writing to the daughter, and hand her the parent's own terms: help that keeps them in their own home and independent, 'not a nursing home', 'not a burden'. The parent-side evidence is thinner than the daughter page (most themes hold 5 to 40 documents), so treat it as directional, not as volume.

Contents

1. Who the parent is (measured)
2. Fears
3. Hopes & Dreams
4. Relationship Fears
5. What they say to their family
6. Frustrations
7. What they have tried
8. What they wish existed
9. Desired Outcomes
10. A typical day
11. Ailments & needs
12. What they refuse, and why
13. Dislikes
14. Ads addressed to the parent
15. Sources, method and gaps

1. Who the parent is (measured)

5,407 documents in the parent's own voice from 4,013 people; 2,407 state an age (median 72).

Age band	People
60–64	193
65–69	621
70–74	626
75–79	465
80–84	310
85–89	131
90+	61

What they say about their life	People
gender: woman	475
has children	415
widowed	366
gender: man	330
married, spouse living	309
retired	250
lives alone	213
divorced	76
no children	65
paid help comes in	55
fixed income / Social Security	43
lives with spouse	31
stopped driving	29
still drives	27
worried about money running out	24
nobody helps	13
lives with an adult child	10
children help	10
lives in a senior community / facility	5
veteran	4
children live far away	3
spouse is the helper	2

Profile (a read of the numbers)

- An older adult in their late 60s to 80s, often widowed and living alone with more than one condition, who wants to stay in their own home, fears the nursing home, the money running out and becoming a burden on their children, and who accepts help when it reads as independence rather than care.

Who they are

- Age: median 72 among 2,407 people who state it; 65–69: 621, 70–74: 626, 75–79: 465, 80–84: 310, 85–89: 131, 90+: 61.
- Household: widowed 366; married with a living spouse 309; say they live alone 213; live with an adult child 10.
- Children: 415 mention their children; 65 say they have none.
- Money: 43 mention a fixed income or Social Security; 24 say they worry it will run out.
- Driving: 27 say they still drive; 29 say they have stopped.
- Conditions they name most about themselves: loneliness (137), cancer (108), memory (90), hearing (87), falls and balance (87), arthritis (83), depression or anxiety (102).

What they believe

- A read: 'I'm fine, I can still manage' is the reason they give first when a facility comes up.
- A read: a facility is the end of the road. Some say they would rather die at home, even if it means being found late, than go in.
- A read: needing help makes them a burden. Some conclude the kind thing is to tell their children in advance to place them.
- A read, said by them and about them: hearing aids and walkers make you look old, and assisted living is 'living with old people'.

What stops them accepting help

- Their home, memories, pets and their own schedule: 51 staying-put statements, with independence and home the reasons given most.
- Strangers in the house, as their children report it (24 quotes).
- Cost on a fixed income: facilities at thousands a month, and alert or hearing-aid contracts they cannot get out of (see Dislikes).
- Being treated like a child by their own children: few posts (5), sharp language.

The moment things change

- A read from the voices: a fall, especially one where they could not get up or reach a phone.
- The death of a spouse, which leaves them alone in the house.
- Losing the car or the licence.
- A diagnosis or a surgery (cancer, memory, heart, a hip or knee) that means weeks of needing help.

The frame that works (hypothesis)

- Hypothesis: help that keeps you in your own home and keeps your children from carrying it; not a nursing home, not a stranger taking over. Show the parent choosing it, on their terms.

2. Fears

Theme	Documents
The money running out	26
Ending up in a nursing home	20
Becoming a burden to my children	18

Pain and a drawn-out end	17
Not being able to do for myself	12
Falling, and lying there with no one to help	11
Losing my mind: dementia, memory	11
Losing the car and the freedom it gives	10
Losing my spouse, being left alone	9
Dying alone, found days later	6

The money running out — 26

">don't borrow trouble from the future. This. The biggest variance from youth to old age is in regards to planning for the future. As a young person you *have* to plan. As an old person you *cannot* plan. I'm 62 and in good health, so I might make it another 40 years. Or, I could drop dead tomorrow; I have no idea. I have enough money saved up for the "worst" scenario, so I try not to worry about it. Happiness (especially for the elderly) comes from living in the moment."

r/AskOldPeople · 104 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/q4cewj/my_dad_doesnt_want_to_live_in_a_nursing_home_when/hfxtch8/

"I'm 55m, gay, with same partner for 30 years. A lot of my friends died of AIDS in the 80s/90s and some are still suffering the consequences (HIV dementia etc) even with modern therapies. So that's my background. NOW ... at 55 .. most of my friends are in the 50-65 age group and they are starting to die of various things. Brain tumours, cancers, consequences of 30 years of taking happy drugs etc. Death is not a fear but I can feel it biting my heels. We have had a successful life so currently we are considering retiring and using up some of our savings etc (hubby is 63) to just bugger off and explore and travel which has always been our passion. We have a big art collection (probably not ..."

r/AskOldPeople · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/11qdney9/how_did_you_come_to_an_acceptance_of_aging/jc2wsxm/

"My parents money ran out and they now reside in a Medicaid nursing home. My dad was a grocery store manager for 40 years. Mom worked part time occasionally but mainly stayed at home. As a grocery store manager my dad moved up a few times because he was assigned to another store (local chain nothing out of state). My parents never worried about money because they had enough to live like they wanted which was pretty frugal. Even though my dad bought a few houses and cars, there was never really any extra money to invest in retirement. He retired from the grocery business at 62 and began drawing his social security and also too a low paying part time job, first selling insurance door to door, t..."

r/retirement · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1v25nzy/has_anyone_on_here_actually_run_out_of_money/oz2dzwu/

Ending up in a nursing home — 20

"I am 94 years old and still live alone . Not in a stick and bricks home but in 28' motorhome that I still drive and move every 2-3 weeks from one campgroun to another. I locate, back into my site, hook up the electric, water and sewer. Then set my jacks, extend my slide out and rearrange the inside from travel mode to stay put mode. I also work on listing jewelry on eBay and make the phone calls on my list of things to take care of. So far I can manage it all but some chores are difficult. One park is my favorite and my home base. I have friends in the park and Rv techs to call for repairs and fixes. I have my groceries delivered. I do not want to live with my daughters and they did tell me ..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 360 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLGMbc&lc=Ugx6fGhU40zdvpPcx9V4AaABAq>

"I am 79 years old. I take no medication. I am fit and heathy for my age. I never want to go into any care home, I want to enjoy my life in my own home until I die here"

r/Aging · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Aging/comments/1s2o0zy/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9kxvw/

"By the time I'm old they'll have assisted suicide for old folks on demand without having to have a terminal illness first. Pretty sure that will be an option and many people will choose it. As for me personally, I'm not scared of ending up in a nursing home. Could happen, but I'm not spending energy right now being scared of it. Plenty of other things taking up my fear energy at the moment!"

r/AskOldPeople · 69 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/12r0py5/are_you_afraid_of_ending_up_in_a_nursing_home/jgsao75/

Becoming a burden to my children — 18

"This might be the stupidest thing I've ever done, but I just feel like I want to unload my mind I'm about to turn 60, and it feels like I'm going in slow motion to the end and I can't do anything to stop it. Not only do I have no money, no pension, no 401k, I'm also about \$35K in debt, half of that is family loans. I can go into detail if anyone needs it, but its the same ole sad story about relationships gone bad, business dealings gone bad, generally a bunch of bad decisions. From age 18-30, I was great at managing money, but a couple of divorces and job losses wiped that out. Lets just say two people left the marriage richer than when it started. Right now I'm in a foreign country teachin..."

r/over60 · 543 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1jo3srf/this_might_be_the_stupidest_thing_ive_ever_done/

"This is probably a very American Healthcare influenced answer, but my real anxiety isn't leaving enough for my kids, it's leaving them with medical debt from our insanely expensive palliative care environment. I WANT to enjoy my money now, but I also watched my grandparents go into a retirement community with literal millions only to watch them be milked down to zero when they were relatively low need. You should enjoy your earned wealth while you're here, but the nagging fear of destitution in old age and becoming a burden on children is what drives me to hoard."

r/AskOldPeople · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/10ck8zk/marie_osmond_says_she_is_not_giving_her_8/j4ir3s9/

"52 male here. Three years widowed after 24 years of marriage. That's very hard in many ways. But people don't seem to get that, as an old country song said (and Hank Williams' grandson sings a good cover of it): "I'm not lonely, I'm just lonesome for her." People think I will be happier if I'm out with them. I appreciate that they care. But I miss my sweet wife, and that cannot be replaced. Your post hit me because... I love to sing. I have a good voice and my wife liked it... but not all the dang time. So... now I play music for which she didn't particularly care, and sing out loud to my heart's content. Obviously, I'd give that up in a heartbeat to have her back again. But, like you, I mig..."

r/AskOldPeople · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1e91jkm/whats_your_current_living_situation/leduebj/

Pain and a drawn-out end — 17

"How often do you think about the end of your life? I'm 67 and between my age and climate change, I think about the end of my life most every day. Not afraid of death, but more so suffering in some way. Also I want to be prepared for my daughters sake. She will take it very hard because she has no siblings and I'm her best friend as well. Normal?"

r/AskOldPeople · 141 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/15razn7/how_often_do_you_think_about_the_end_of_your_life/

"I am 70 years old , i am widower for now 14 years! To me life is sad! I'm not afraid of dying!!! Suffer is my main fear! But thank you for your kind video ! I'm.sure it's gonna help some other people! I do believe in God ! I am waiting for him!!! God Bless you all!!! Denis from.France ...My spouse is waiting for me!!!!"

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 79 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=UgynOavUg8D6ODkMzLx4AaABAq>

"I'm jealous of all the people who answered little or none. 7 years ago I was extremely active, worked a very physical job, had quit smoking a few years previously, ate good etc., and had a reasonable expectation of aging well. I'm in my late fifties now, and after multiple back operations I feel and move like a *very* old man. Pain is the dominant issue in my life, unfortunately. Sitting , standing and moving starts a timer running, and it's pathetic how quickly I get to "I'm PAIN and I command you to lie down!" The thing about pain is it wears you out. Consumes all the energy you would formerly put towards fun, interesting things. Hell, I rarely sit and read now, because I can't concentrate..."

r/AskOldPeople · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/q5ysht/how_much_pain_are_you_in/hg9gnkj/

Not being able to do for myself — 12

"I'm also Appalachian and worry that I won't be able to pass on the information of the plants and mushrooms that I eat and use, and all of my recipes and preparation methods. My son and his Scout troop like to be in the woods, but they don't take survival foraging as seriously, they just trust there will always be food in the grocery stores. I'm worried there will not be many people in the next generation eating sochan or dock seeds or day lily bulbs, or using Asarum canadense and Scleroderma citrinum for flavoring, (but without eating them as they are mildly toxic.) I just don't want all of those flavors to die out, I want my grandchildren to know how to find them."

r/AskOldPeople · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/sgu2fw/what_generational_knowledge_do_you_worry_will_end_huzorvj/

"My first chore of the morning is a proof of life text to each of my daughters. Long time widowed, live alone. If I don't text or reply to a text from each of them by 8am or so I might get a panic call, lol. I'm healthy and independent, but it warms my heart that they worry. Coffee, dog walk and shower follow. Now that the weather is nice I sit on the deck, get some morning sun while I peruse the NYT, Reddit and read my current book. The remainder of my day is filled, or not with mundane chores. Gentle exercise, heating pad as needed for aging joints. Now that school is out my youngest granddaughter spends a few hours with me a few days a week while her folks work. Best part of my week."

r/retirement · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1ufbdva/what_are_your_crazy_routines_in_the_morning/ou2t7k8/

"I am 72 yo. I've given birth to 3 children, 1 by C-section. I drink a cup of coffee each morning & I drink soda w/dinner. I occasionally have a beer or 2 on weekends. Otherwise, I drink water & juice. Never smoked & am about 30 lbs overweight. I never had this problem till I started having surgeries almost 3 yrs ago. Started out as 1 back surgery. Then another, then another & finally my last (4th, about 1 yr ago). Instead of being better I am considerably worse. Back pain constantly. Now after last surgery, I have a dropped foot & numbness & tingling in my legs (have to use a walker now). During these surgeries is when my bladder problem started. After last surgery I started to have bowel pr..."

YouTube · How To Fix Urinary Incontinence And Urgency In Females - Urogynecologist Explai · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hvPD Fdf-6MY&lc=UgzbRsGKjbzTbTwLUT94AaABAq>

Falling, and lying there with no one to help — 11

"Mom of four here. For myself and my late husband, there is nothing at all in parenting to equate to being a soldier. It was, overall, a pleasant experience, with some hiccups every once in a while. I have 2 sons still at home, and 2 young adult kids on their own. Parenting was not a "higher calling", that exalts it ridiculously, when all we were doing was having children because they were and are the best manifestations of our love and respect for each other. Part biologic imperative and part love. If I had to supply you with words to describe my feelings of the years I have been a mother, at the top of the list would be **Fun** and **Joy**. We never looked at having kids as a loss of freedo..."

r/AskOldPeople · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/b26x1a/those_with_adult_children_are_you_happy_you_had/eir66i4/

"I just realized today that I hadn't been to town for 10 days! (I live on a farm.) So I just went in and got some fast food just to see some faces. Fortunately, I have tons of animals to keep me company, and I do my volunteer work on-line. You know the thing that's made the most difference to me? My volunteer group set up a **call chain** so that we all call someone else in the group and someone else calls you once a day. Since the volunteers are all over the region, it's nice to hear what's happening in someone else's neck of the woods. But the most important thing about it for me is that if I don't answer (don't have to answer right away if busy, but sometime during the day) they will conta..."

r/AskOldPeople · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/k8cmpz/social_distancing_at_home_has_made_me_feel_lonely/gezwqfm/

"I am 71 years old and my husband passed away almost 11 years ago so I live alone and one of my biggest fears has always been falling and not being able to get back up. Young people (including myself when I was young) have no idea how scary it is when you are alone and you fall and you cannot get back up on your own steam. Total panic sets in. I used to watch the old lady in the "help I've fallen and I can't get up" commercial and like everyone else I thought it was funny. Now I have turned into that old lady and I no longer think it is funny. I actually fell about a year ago and try as I might I could not get up (probably using the very worst techniques) because I tried to roll over and come..."

YouTube · How to get up from the floor (after a fall) - MacGyver style! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4ETgQD8QhZs&lc=UgwpOOnjUEhVsteBVA54AaABAg>

3. Hopes & Dreams

Theme	Documents
To see my grandchildren grow up	33
To stay in my own home to the end	19
To still be useful, to have purpose	17
To never be a burden	16
Someone to share life with	13
A quick, peaceful death, in my sleep or at home	6

To see my grandchildren grow up — 33

"Im 60 years young and if I could go back to my 20 year old self I would never have picked up the bottle , I was an alcoholic for at least 35 years and it robbed me of precious time with my children and grandchildren , I wish with all my heart I could take it back but I cant . We now have a wonderful relationship and we love each other through and through , its never too late but I just wished I never drank to start with .."

YouTube · Life Regrets of 90 Year Olds · 294 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5ARCnE_wo1c&lc=UgzSwtW150e7vjtVSh4AaABAg

"To follow or not to follow kids in retirement Our offspring live too far away for frequent visits -- about a 2.5 hr flight away. I know a lot of retired couples move to be close to their children, maybe because they're hoping their kids will take care of them when they get too old to be independent, maybe because of the draw of grandchildren. My father did not move close to us when he retired, and I'm kinda glad he didn't. We didn't want the worry about leaving him behind if we moved due to a job change or a lifestyle choice. He came to visit a couple times a year. Our kids would go spend a week or so with him in the summer, and they enjoyed getting to see and do things with him that they co..."

r/retirement · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1egg8k2/to_follow_or_not_to_follow_kids_in_retirement/

"My wife's parents provided a paid college tuition at a public state school for each of my three kids. I want to do the same for my grandkids."

r/AskOldPeople · 124 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/10ck8zk/marie_osmond_says_she_is_not_giving_her_8/4g3smc/

To stay in my own home to the end — 19

"I am 79 years old. I take no medication. I am fit and healthy for my age. I never want to go into any care home, I want to enjoy my life in my own home until I die here"

r/Aging · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Aging/comments/1s2o0zy/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9kxvw/

"Thank you. Exactly what I need. I contracted encephalitis late September. I'm 73 years old. And I'm determined to stay in my home. I had a colonoscopy a couple of months ago and was told I have 20 more years! I'm claiming it!! Lol. And I want them all in my home. It's my happy place. I have made an almost full recovery, for which I am truly grateful!! We are fellow Washingtonians!!! Yeah great state."

YouTube · Avoid the Nursing Home With This Simple Plan · 27 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YgT0aiJXA4k&lc=UgyT_Q_8t6pbkzuCALt4AaABAg

"I don't know how old your mom is but IMO you did her a favor. I am 68 and my children live in different states. You need company and help with doctor appts etc as you get older. I wish I lived near one of them and it would be a huge undertaking to sell my house and furniture etc. There is no perfect solution there are days my stuff is comforting but other days I feel burdened. I also think about them having to deal with my stuff if something happened to me. As you age the house becomes hard to manage. It's not shameful you did it with love."

YouTube · The Shocking Truth About DOWNSIZING (No One Talks About) · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mCg4TOcV-fw&lc=UgxN6QRmh6v_7EXVYht4AaABAg_AGzoM3uy_-7AH1JJ1Cpywg

To still be useful, to have purpose — 17

"I'm also 66 and I'll get depressed twice a year but somehow I find the strength to carry on. I'm a veteran and my health care services have deteriorated because we have lost so many health care professionals. If you can call them that. I'll have my blood drawn once a year and meet with a doctor in a video conference. There's no touch, no close exam, no listening to your heartbeat. I find time for the garden and try to use my garden herbs when I feel unwell. I'm staying alive because I have a disabled adult son and truth be told, I am just so darn curious about what will happen next. I have some skills in health care and hope that I could be useful to others. My age has started to show the la..."

r/over60 · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1sdpaif/accepting_im_getting_old/oek9265/

"I'm not but thank you ❤️ "these horrible times" doesn't apply to me. I did this job years ago, before kids, for three years, but once I had kids it was too hard to be a mom and do this. I hope to volunteer now that my kids are young adults. When I did this I was only 30, and felt invincible and did not relate to the patients as a potential patient myself. Since then I've had cancer and have been in remission for several years, so while I'm doing well, it's too hard emotionally to do that job now. That job taught me so much about life and people. It's when I learned about boundaries. It also taught me you can do any job with great coworkers! Also, I would not say that there is overwhelming sa..."

r/AskOldPeople · 98 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1ikws22/what_is_it_like_to_know_youre_starting_to_develop/mbr55aa/

"Love, love, love this post. I'm also 69y female feeling much the same. I'm still adjusting to retirement as of 12/2023. Took on a per diem job as I was getting lost in retirement and succumbing to a sedentary life. So waking up today and reading your post puts an emphasis on the need to move more. My purpose, mmmm, my goal is to move closer to family in California (I'm in New York). Next year will be my best year! Thanks again for your post."

r/retirement · 60 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1bp306p/what_is_your_purpose_at_69_years_old/kwszx40/

To never be a burden — 16

"To follow or not to follow kids in retirement Our offspring live too far away for frequent visits -- about a 2.5 hr flight away. I know a lot of retired couples move to be close to their children, maybe because they're hoping their kids will take care of them when they get too old to be independent, maybe because of the draw of grandchildren. My father did not move close to us when he retired, and I'm kinda glad he didn't. We didn't want the worry about leaving him behind if we moved due to a job change or a lifestyle choice. He came to visit a couple times a year. Our kids would go spend a week or so with him in the summer, and they enjoyed getting to see and do things with him that they co..."

r/retirement · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1egg8k2/to_follow_or_not_to_follow_kids_in_retirement/

"That sounds like something I would have written. I'm in my 70s and there is no way I could afford what they charge. Apartment rents or even a one room hotel room are outrageous and ridiculous. Thankfully I don't have kids who will put me into a home, and take every last nickel they can get. I look at dying differently now. I see it more as a release, a way out of what our world has become, and hope it happens before I can't take care of myself anymore."

YouTube · Assisted Living Warning · 55 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f3z5AK9tCMs&lc=UgwvBd6tp9nQO879JGJ4AaABAg.9zkge9Kp_hR8A-h1WSasiFX

"Grandma you are doing great. I talk to myself all the time. I have my alarm set to take my cancer pill. Even so I feel like not again, but I have to take them. Yesterday I did not feel like eating, so I opened a pack of cup of soup added some frozen broccoli and 1/4 potatoe. At least you have all your meals planned and frozen. I am so proud of how you run your life independently. We all feel at our age that hope we will not be a burden. The Lord has given you a tranquil home to enjoy and lovely son and family who are close. Enjoy your life. I am in my 70s and survived cancer. The Lord has great things in store for me, as reaching the young age of 92. and more May He continue to bless you and g..."

YouTube · How I Simplify My Life at 92 to Stay Independent Living Alone · 14 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mzGu6d6UxIQ&lc=Ugwak4acBWE2CLP4lm14AaABAg>

Someone to share life with — 13

"As a 79 yr old i ca identify with a lot here..however i read ,have a good video library.and a dog,also i as a christian i go to church not to meet people but it is the high moment of my life when i really invite the risen lord into my life and cherish Him as a very close companion who i confide in in total confidence and am open to the promptings of the holy spirit.my day consists of prayer,cooking,house cleaning and walking the dog.i read and look at tv just for a few hours and keep up with the news listening to the radio aswell.Ihope if you ar reading this do not be lonely,be alone its ok..but not lonely"

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 99 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=UgyhCENj-Kn3wLzhMYV4AaABAg>

"I'm 72 & am thinking of my dogs as well. One is ten, the other twelve. I can't imagine life without a dog companion so I hope they go before me."

YouTube · Aging in the U.S. (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMDsUdhymbQ&lc=Ugy5m3u1IUuElc_H8CAJ4AaABAg.9tBjHdJg9dh9tJT2AAAdJK

"When I feel I need to say what I think out loud I talk to my two cats who adoringly sit or lie down and listen I truly believe they understand me, as they often glance at each other in agreement or not agree to what I have said to them, they keep me company and still play me up when they are in a mood to do so. I have hobbies and I rarely talk to a human unless I have to go to the doctor or a optician as I don't go shopping now I shop on line and delivery people with food always have a chat the rest are so in a hurry but always use manners. I have a neighbor and we phone each other weekly to catch up on things in the neighborhood neither of us can walk about more than 100 MRTs so we stopped ..."

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=Ugy4EQiyag8UfGLuHU4AaABAq_A8HySBS7c86A8mpdbleQ6R

A quick, peaceful death, in my sleep or at home — 6

"I am 86 years old and my daily prayer is that when its my time I will go quickly. My children want to take care of me but I have seen children taking care of the elderly and its too much. I'm going to live on my own for as long as possible. My greatest fear is losing my ability to care for myself and to get dementia. So far, I am doing quite well."

YouTube · Assisted Living Warning · 95 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f3z5AK9tCMs&lc=Ugz2sZiJW07sWHwPpYx4AaABAq>

"I'm 89 yrs old & don't have much quality of life anymore. I wish I could just go peacefully to sleep, forever. Bless your Aunt."

YouTube · Aging in the U.S. (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 58 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMDsUdhymbQ&lc=UgzPgSOmoMW6ThstdiJ4AaABAq.9vRnf-izL909xaCbBVDtc3>

"Wow, as a retired RN who spent most of my career in geriatrics. I applaud you ❤️ ❤️ ❤️ I am now 68 with some major crap going on. I want to die at home...but... if I had to go to extended care, I would love to come to your facility. What State are you located in?? Keep up the good work. My main complaint while working was..... I could not love on my patients enough because of patient load. By the time I got the necessities done, I hadn't spent any real time with my patients 😞 . God Bless you all!"

YouTube · Aging in the U.S. (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMDsUdhymbQ&lc=Ugwt8GZEwxZUnYHtg5Z4AaABAq.9tGDjXL42vh9tLPL03IYYK>

4. Relationship Fears

Theme	Documents
Being a burden on my children	36
Children far away, busy, or not calling	29
Caring for, or losing, my husband or wife	24
Money, the will and the inheritance	12
My children pushing me to move or give things up	10
Children worrying, checking, hovering	6
Being treated like a child	5

Being a burden on my children — 36

"Deliberately shrinking the footprint - our personal strategy Sorry for the length. I'm looking for reactions to our approach to downsizing and staying out of managed care. We've watched a number of people our age dealing with parents who are forced to move out of a giant home they've lived in for forty years but can no longer manage, directly into assisted living and giving up essentially all their familiar belongings in the process - a huge emotional shock, often resisted tooth and nail. My wife and I downsized 7 or 8 years ago, halving the size of our house. This enabled us to pay it off in five years, but also required us to lose a whole bunch of furniture and assorted "stuff". This is no..."

r/retirement · 639 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/194w810/deliberately_shrinking_the_footprint_our_personal/

"I'm really surprised at the negative comments here. I am 68 and I feel this way. What is the point of making it way past what would have been your expiration point if you are a burden to your family? And if you read this sub you know that is the underlying theme in of all our posts. Guilt, exhaustion, and the degradation of our own personal aging experience is bringing my generation to its knees. All of my friends who are doing well lost their parents at an age where they didn't have to assume crushing guilt and overwhelming support needs. Other cultures let nature take its course and revere their elders. I had a really good friend who was a Lakota spiritual leader and he said covid was moth..."

Reddit · 119 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9od8g/

"I am at that time when living alone may be dangerous, or just too many things to do that I can not do, and then being alone is intolerable. Fortunately, my children love me enough to come clear across the country to help me pack up and move. I will divide up my time with them, so none of them has the full time burden of me living with one of them. I know that at any time I could need more physical help, at that time, I will hope for death or be moved to a care facility. But for now, I am so fortunate that my children want me to spend time with them."

YouTube · What to Do When Elderly Parents Can't Live Alone · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oOIWdNaA4Fs&lc=Ugya9p7o-h9VJcPvKph4AaABAg>

Children far away, busy, or not calling — 29

"Gene Hackman's death Infrequently, someone will inquire about who will care for the my husband and I in our dotage since we have no children. We are "Plan for the worst & hope for the best" types and we have recently moved from the farm to a town home all on one level and more easily accessible to services. We have no children. We are not parents. I do hear a certain amount of venting about children from our friends who are parents and grandparents. Kids who don't call, hurt feelings and the like. I understand. I read Gene Hackman had advanced Alzheimer's. He may have lived in his home for up to a week with the deceased body of his wife before he died. Mr Hackman had grown children. Police w..."

r/over60 · 899 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1j77lgw/gene_hackmans_death/

"My husband and I retired at 60, sold our house and moved all the way across the country to a 55+ community in a state we've never been to. We love it here. I have taken up horseback riding. Our Financial Advisor told me I should buy a horse (if that would make me happy). My husband said we need to look for a new Financial Advisor immediately. 😂 "

r/retirement · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1tim07y/whoopsies_learnings_from_regrettable_decisions_in/omwu4ed/

"A lot of us--I'm 71--don't because they have all died, and if we have children, they've moved far away and don't communicate or visit much. Sometimes a person such as the one you met, is helped just by someone considering them worth talking to."

r/over60 · 57 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1sps3zz/riding_the_bus_the_other_day/oh3jt5z/

Caring for, or losing, my husband or wife — 24

"I'm 78 years old, my wife died 5 years ago, in the beginning it was hard after 50 years of marriage but now I'm feel better (time heals) I'm enjoy seniors club, I still missing her."

YouTube · 9 Benefits of Living Alone as an Older Man · 55 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L1dqJO-OIPo&lc=UgxNlaff8uGPh8nwPnd4AaABAq>

"I am 71 years old and my husband passed away almost 11 years ago so I live alone and one of my biggest fears has always been falling and not being able to get back up. Young people (including myself when I was young) have no idea how scary it is when you are alone and you fall and you cannot get back up on your own steam. Total panic sets in. I used to watch the old lady in the "help I've fallen and I can't get up" commercial and like everyone else I thought it was funny. Now I have turned into that old lady and I no longer think it is funny. I actually fell about a year ago and try as I might I could not get up (probably using the very worst techniques) because I tried to roll over and come..."

YouTube · How to get up from the floor (after a fall) - MacGyver style! · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4ETgQD8QhZs&lc=UgwpO0njUEhVsteBVA54AaABAq>

"My wife died in 2018 I'm 72 and the enjoy my solitude very seldom very lonely. Had a lot of good years with my wife now I do what I want when I want. 😊 "

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=UgziDL6D9qJBYYfl_eJ4AaABAq.A8SUX06qd7VA8kfByB4vfu

Money, the will and the inheritance — 12

"I was friends with high school people after we graduated but then I was drafted into the military, the only one in my class. When I came back I looked up some of them and they were just like they were in high school while my experiences had changed me. So, that was it, I lost all contact even though I lived in the same city (a large one.). Move ahead 40-some years. I'd moved away, halfway across the country, and started a whole new life. If my school had reunions, I didn't know about them. After I retired I became curious and decided to track down the one guy I had in all my classes and we'd hung out a lot. It took some doing but I found him. It turned out that after his parents passed away..."

r/over60 · 100 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1k08a4n/those_high_school_reunions/mnc3kxq/

"I am 78 and my wonderful wife of 51 years died 3 years ago. I have a 7 room house 2100 sq ft. Others have suggested downsizing. I decided one of the most important elements to living here for 45 years are my neighbors. Most of them are now young professionals and are extremely good to me. When I had a heart attack 2 years ago, neighbors on both sides of me automatically shovelled my snow. My daughter and family live walking distance from my house and I see them daily. My son lives 10 minutes away and phones me daily. I use everything but two rooms in my house. If I went through the cost of selling this house (real estate fees, lawyers fees, physical, moving fees, decorating a new house) I do..."

YouTube · The Shocking Truth About DOWNSIZING (No One Talks About) · 71 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mCg4TOcV-fw&lc=UgxswLuPT-azuMSRogR4AaABAq>

"I'm 86 and I agree with her completely. I just don't care what others, people or corporations, are thinking. I have my own interests. I love my family, living alone and doing nothing productive. I'm not worried about leaving my descendants a good inheritance, only about whether I have enough money to see me through to the end."

YouTube · I'm 92. Here's 7 Things I Stopped Caring About (And Why You Should Too) · 61 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RsPXYI0Nhhk&lc=UgyZ0gKL6pNQwyacxHl4AaABAq>

My children pushing me to move or give things up — 10

"Same here. My son is on another continent but wants me to downsize. Without help, the deal is that I will move when I've disposed of all the clutter of the past 50 years, a bit at a time."

YouTube · The Truth About Downsizing and Decluttering: What No One Tells You, but You Need · 37 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5F5NQPzR6HA&lc=UgyKXJtrZrf25OGpavZ4AaABAq.AC2krYJHkovAC424-QWlkh>

"That's what I was thinking putting a camera in their room if they did maybe they treat them like the king and queen I bet that place is closed down now I had to live in one for a while after I got out of the hospital they charged me \$5000.00 monthly but I have to I had one worker I didn't care for my physical therapy lady told me to get a nurses aid to help me go to the bathroom I'm saying in the wheelchair to the bathroom cuz it was hard to get over the bump in the bathroom and she was arguing with me she just didn't want to do anything she wouldn't let me talk she just kept on you can do it I kept saying I couldn't I told on her I told them I didn't want her in my room but I had to have a ..."

YouTube · Life and Death in Assisted Living (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j5wxhOslUfE&lc=Ugxc1fZ7QyjW-vM6kod4AaABAq.9dQUNetv-e99dg37MTVn5q>

"As I go through things I put them in piles for each kid & my ex whether it's pictures, stories they wrote, cards, letters, awards, pictures they drew etc. I take pictures or scan the ones I think are special and then hand them off to the kids for them to decide what they want. Realistically they aren't just my memories, they are theirs also. I tell them that they get to decide what to toss. I took a large batch of photos from my daughters wedding to her. As she went through them she was surprised that she hadn't seen many of them. It was fun to see her discovering pictures that she didn't have and wanting to keep many of them. I'd already scanned the ones I wanted so they were all hers. I've..."

YouTube · The Truth About Downsizing and Decluttering: What No One Tells You, but You Need · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5F5NQPzR6HA&lc=UgyHbNQqifzXEpojKbh4AaABAq.AC4MhxHuRwmAC5_B03PZhk

Children worrying, checking, hovering — 6

"I retired at 66 and was invisible and forgotten by 67. The business still exists, my name is on the bottom of some drawings, and I get a Christmas card from a couple of friends. I have my dog, my wife, my house and my days are full with homely tasks, like tending my garden, chatting with a neighbor, washing my car. I'm not important now, and in truth, never was, not really. The important things in my life now are walking the dog on time and making my wife laugh. I was past ready to retire, so when I cast the burden down, it was a relief. Sometimes I think that I should do something important with the rest of my life, but then I take a nap with my dog and I feel better. Life is good now, no m..."

r/retirement · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1mmrkbq/struggling_a_bit_with_how_small_my_life_is/n89ovz4/

"I'm 67 and live alone I'm also retired but I have a very sweet daughter that checks on me everyday and refuses to let me feel lonely. I am a introvert but I like people a few at a time however when I retired there went those I would communicate with I did try and keep in touch but something happens when u retire people don't reach out or call. It's almost like well we don't see each other anymore so there goes the relationship or whatever. This is what happened to me and my very best friend moved to another state we use to do fun things together and talk a lot sharing world issues and daily stuff. It is true that it's hard to motivate myself sometimes but I do and I stay on top of medical th..."

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 18 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=UgxmWqpwOTXveid74sx4AaABAq.A8LcZ2UjFSDA8LgYW7_s0J

"I'm sorry for your loss. Each of us is responsible for our own lives, our own self education, health, choices and so on. I am 67 and i actually try and insulate my children from my health problems. They have enough to deal with in their own lives and I suppose at some point in the future it's possible I'll become a burden to them but I hope not. The last thing I want is for them to worry about me given the challenges they face establishing themselves in their careers, starting families, learning to be parents, dealing with student loans and so on. We prepare our children for adulthood and take pleasure in seeing them do well. We do not raise them to care for us in our dotage."

r/AskOldPeople · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/hfdwl3/when_would_you_expect_your_adult_children_to_take/fvxlwgh/

5. What they say to their family

Theme	Documents
'No strangers in my house'	30 (6 own, 24 quoted by a child)
'Don't put me in a home' / 'I'm not moving'	14 (10 own, 4 quoted by a child)
'I'm fine' / 'I can manage'	12 (4 own, 8 quoted by a child)
'I don't want to be a burden'	11 (3 own, 8 quoted by a child)
'Put me in a home if I get dementia'	7 (6 own, 1 quoted by a child)

'No strangers in my house' — 30

"For some reason my wife feels like she has to do 8 hour days when she goes there . She has four sisters and only one other sister really helps out . They have a caregiver every day but she constantly gets calls at night from her father say you're mom pooped. It's sad ! It could go on for years we're in our 60s ."

YouTube · I Don't Want to Care for My Elderly Parent · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Xx2bxgWEC_4&lc=UgxXOugNwUUAozqo5TN4AaABAq

"KFF Health News - The New Old Age 04/28/2025 - When They Don't Recognize You Anymore from the link: [excerpts] Stewart [the daughter in this storied example] remembers thinking, "In the natural course of things, you were supposed to die before me. But you were never supposed to forget who I am." Later, alone, she wept. People with advancing dementia do regularly fail to recognize beloved spouses, partners, children, and siblings. By the time Stewart and her youngest brother moved Cole into a memory-care facility a year later, she had almost completely lost the ability to remember their names or their relationship to her. "It's pretty universal at the later stages" of the disease, said Alison..."

AARP Community · When They Don't Recognize You Anymore · <https://community.aarp.org/caregiving-connect-10/when-they-don-t-recognize-you-anymore-4345>

"I'm 63 Years Old A Life of Wisdom Through Out My Life,so Have Gone Though Major Shifts In Life,I Was Stepchild To My Stepsybilling, I Was Protected By My Grandmother & Mom (That Both My Grandmother & Mom Told Me We Were of Native American Indian Heritage,That Both My Father Burton Mills Grey Had Native American Algonquin Blood,So Did Mom & Grandmother,&I Was Native Algonquin Indian) 0:40 ,Until I Was 8 Years old,When Our Grandmother,Died,Christ Day Night 1970,I Was Sexually Molested By My 3 rd Stepsybilling Richard, That Confused Me on What I Suppose to do.,Then After Grandmother's Funeral,Is When The Physical & Psyological Abuse Started,(Knew I Was Different From My Stepsybillings & I Knew How..."

YouTube · I'm 92. Here's 7 Things I Stopped Caring About (And Why You Should Too) · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RsPXYI0Nhhk&lc=UgyhdnIUskUVVOOmNKF4AaABAq>

"I'm throwing in the towel My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden , and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuri..."

r/CaregiverSupport · as told by their child · 222 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden , and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressur..."

r/CaregiverSupport · as told by their child · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

'Don't put me in a home' / 'I'm not moving' — 14

"Lesson Learned: You have to be YOUR OWN ADVOCATE with medical emergencies! Warning: Long post: 64M, Married, live in Southern CO. Retired. Learned a very painful lesson (literally) this week. I have a long history of knee issues, partially due to 23 years in the Army but also just people in my family have bad knees. I had had a couple of minor but annoying medical issues pop up earlier in the year. An abdominal hematoma that we don't know the cause of (my theory is too much ibuprofen from various aches and pains thinned my blood) and then a planned nasal surgery (sepotplasty) which I have to say is one of the most unpleasant experiences I've ever had. So after spending all day Wednesday chan..."

r/over60 · 246 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1tmw6zd/lesson_learned_you_have_to_be_your_own_advocate/

"AITA for thinking about leaving my wife for being an unfit mother So before I make any hasty decisions I really need some consulting, mainly from my elders, preferably ones that have been married, or are still married and who have raised children with their spouse. If you happen to be younger than I am (below 30) but want to chime in, feel free, but I really want to hear from people that have children or have experienced marriage. Before I explain what happened this morning, I'll give you a little bit of backstory: I just turned 30 in July, my wife is going on 27, so we're a fairly young couple. We've been married for about 3 years but we've known each other a lot longer. I work a very busy ..."

r/AskOldPeople · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/crqtqg/aita_for_thinking_about_leaving_my_wife_for_being/

"It truly is about the peace and quietness don't fool yourself I've been single since 1984 I'm 74 right now so it's been 30 years peace and quiet as everything I come home when I want I go where I want I spend money where I want had a friend of mine say what's so fun about your life you don't do anything and I tell that's exactly what I'm not going to do at the moment nothing"

YouTube · 9 Benefits of Living Alone as an Older Man · 4 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=L1dqJO-OIPo&lc=UgwXhh5RcpcYtTN-hhl4AaABAq>

"it's about phases, you can't keep living without changing your lifestyle to fit your phase. i worked hard to get my parents into a retirement community, it had so many great things i wanted to move there. my parents have been know it alls, narcissistic, all my life, it would have been a great end phase, but my mom said i'm not moving...but they can't drive, my sister's and i did the driving for a couple years, then they hired someone for 3 days a week, but covid hit and they couldn't have someone coming in, so we're back to driving to all these appointments, because they didn't transition to their new phase, old people phase, you ride shuttles to appointments, your world does shrink. we chan..."

YouTube · ELDERLY PARENTS FEEL ENTITLED? What might make a selfish aging parent tick and w · as told by their child · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ruyStd12qwl&lc=Ugyhdk4SbyQa-FAYWnJ4AaABAq>

"My mother tried to undress in front of me and my husband the other day. I asked why she was taking her shirt off and she said, "I'm not going to take a bath in my clothes!" It was not bath time."

r/dementia · as told by their child · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1skffg6/my_mom_just_pooped_in_full_view_of_the_ofzq185/

'I'm fine' / 'I can manage' — 12

"I'm gonna be 71 next week and so far I don't need any assistance BUT no matter how many times I tell my two granddaughters to stop they insist on either texting or calling me daily to remind me to take my meds. I remember. I'm not that forgetful yet, I love them both and their husbands too, what's his name and the other guy."

r/AskOldPeople · 96 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/16jdw17/how_do_we_help_you_for_the_70_crowd/k0p598/

"I hear you about the phone thing, 9 out of 10 people I see are looking at a phone at any given instance. My parents were my best friends. My (estranged) brother is married to a much younger woman who is "all about the inheritance". The few women I had associated with beg to differ, it is all about the kids & grandkids, I have been told by them "they don't need a man to rationalize their existence" I'm just spreading their good word! Even in their old age they still play games like they were still in High School. If you want to feel needed, get a pet. At this point in our lives we are pretty much set in our ways. It would be difficult to change, make new friends & associates. I find I have le..."

AARP Community · Ladies 70 and older - share your tips for dating sites · 1 likes · <https://community.aarp.org/friends-family-33/ladies-70-and-older-share-your-tips-for-dating-sites-444?postid=212856>

"Thank You I will check in with the LOA office. I have relatives in Idaho and Pennsylvania. I guess it will be a discussion with my son to see which state he is interested in. He was the one that said we should relocate. I feel bad for him as my only remaining son, he feels pressure of being the only child and thinks he is responsible for replacing his brother/father. I keep telling him that I can do it and he has his own life to live. He has yet to deal with the deaths of his brother, father and uncle. It has been 6 1/2 months since I lost my son, husband and brother. Do you think I am making decisions to relocate too soon? It is so nice to have a format to ask these questions and to have th..."

AARP Community · 🧡 WE are thinking of YOU! Please Stop By To See Us :) · <https://community.aarp.org/grief-loss-11/we-are-thinking-of-you-please-stop-by-to-see-us-1220?postid=202765>

"I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting boundaries) because you're upset with him and cons..."

Reddit · as told by their child · 171 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op30xw5/

"I really needed this video. Dad is in process if getting diagnosed. I have tried for ten years but my parents covered for each other and he refused to go to the doctor. Mom passed and now dad is a lot worse still months later. MRI shows problems but neurologist follow up appt isn't until a few weeks. Dad thinks he can drive and doesn't need any help. I am watching your videos and soaking up all the info I can. You are truly an angel on Earth with helping all of us care for our loved ones. Thank you."

YouTube · How To Convince Someone With Dementia They Need Help · as told by their child · 154 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ncKhXQtnyfl&lc=Ugw006LHu0dPqn16d-x4AaABAg>

'I don't want to be a burden' — 11

"Agree. My folks always said that "best thing they could do for us (their kids) was to make sure they weren't a burden in their old age". I have kids in their 30s. And we live in a very high cost area. A starter home is over 1m. And I mean starter. That's hard to overcome without help."

r/retirement · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1ft1gb9/what_millennials_are_saying_about_retirement/lpust59/

"I've already told my sons that when I need it, put me in a nursing home. I won't fight them about it because I trust their judgement and I don't want to be a burden on them. Right now, at 81, I am able to take care of myself without any problem, but I know a time will come when I will need help to do the basic things. As long as I can read and listen to the radio I'm pretty sure I can handle anything else."

YouTube · Avoid the Nursing Home With This Simple Plan · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YgT0aiJXA4k&lc=UgzopS6vsoHCQkiBL2Z4AaABAg>

"My parents took their parents into our home. They had 3 kids, to take care of. My grandfather had a stroke was bedridden in one room, my grandmother who had a failing heart, also bedridden. My mother did it all, no complaints. I am 78 and I hope I can stay in my home, if not I won't be a burden to them, one way or the other."

YouTube · The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzkZillmP-JBIs-4CZ4AaABAg

"Mom offended when someone acknowledged her burden on me. During my daily call to my mom she said our relative mentioned that it was sad that I was spending my 'life taking care of old people'. (I'm POA for my mom and another elderly relative.) My mom said she was offended by her cousin's comment and countered that she couldn't be a burden on me because she lives in independent living. She told me the story as if our relative was being ridiculous and expected me to deny that she was burden, but I bit my tongue. Sure, I'm fortunate that both elderly people arrange care for live in senior housing, so they're not daily *burdens* on me. But I was chagrined that my mom thought she was independent ..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 309 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n2xzcp/mom_offended_when_someone_acknowledged_her_burden/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a ki..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

'Put me in a home if I get dementia' — 7

"I've told my kids to put me in a home if and when I'm unable to look after myself. I would never put them through the stress I'm currently going through. I didn't bring them into this world for them to put their lives on hold when I'm old. I brought them into the world to fulfil their dreams and I'm never going to stand in the way of them."

YouTube · How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TED · 258 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgxKMXhAhCoWXobEvxJ4AaABAg>

"@kikihowe4799 I'm 72 and I already told my kids and husband that if I have dementia to put me in a home."

YouTube · Husbands Love and Dementia: Clare and Mandy · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K0m9B9810ms&lc=Ugy3X9wdzyrR75AaXnJ4AaABAg.8lo_O90d2PS9JGSpVjv58G

"You ever been in a facility lately? I've told both my children to put me in a facility and they've both refused. We've had the hard talks. I've told them I'm a prime candidate for Alzheimer's. My son who has made a huge effort to look into facilities and he flat refuses. I have a dnr. It's the best I can do to keep from burdening my kids. Sometimes kids love their parent enough to make the hard decisions and decide to keep their loved one at home. You sound like you need a break, help, support. You sound burnt out and overwhelmed. I am so so sorry this is happening to you. I will think of you when I meditate. ❤️❤️"

YouTube · The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxS8W63Oi37uoSwJb14AaABAg

"I feel this post to the bottom of my soul. Wiping up diarrhea off the floor, spending over two hours to get my mom into the shower, cutting toe nails, and waking up at four in the morning to get my mom back into bed because she ended up kneeling on the floor to pick up imaginary items that fell is not heart-warming or a privilege. It's a sentence. Twenty years ago, my mom said. "Just put me in a home if I get dementia. I won't know the difference anyway." Well, she's been living with us for 9 years with dementia. If I mention a facility, she gets defensive and backtracks on what she said. She is with it enough to know the difference, so I guess a facility is out of the question in her mind. ..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/oc1sa02/

6. Frustrations

Theme	Documents
A body that won't do what it did	13
Doctors, Medicare and insurance	13
The quiet, lonely house	10
Phones, technology, scam calls	7

A body that won't do what it did — 13

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone..

[https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/]
 (https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/)

First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and cha..."

r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/

"My family is pretending that I am not in early stage dementia. I'm 70 years old and I can feel my mind going. My memory is just terrible but more than that I find myself starting to not understand normal things. The other day I lost my credit card at the gas pump because I put it in slot where the receipts come out, the attendant was quite nice about helping me get my card back and not condescending at all. Another day I was driving along when I suddenly I had no idea where I was, I mean no idea, after about 5 to 10 seconds I saw a land mark and it all came back to me. I can't really talk to my family about this because they are in denial. I have rather minor type 2 diabetes and whenever I a..."

r/dementia · 507 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ks49fe/my_family_is_pretending_that_i_am_not_in_early/

"How much joint pain is "that's just life" and how much is "you've got a problem"? This all started virtually overnight. One day I'm celebrating my first year without a period, and the next I wake up achy. Now it's a daily thing. Increasingly weak and aching joints. I was concerned enough to get tested for Rheumatoid Arthritis, but the test came back negative. So now I'm just trying to figure out how to live with this, or even how to make it disappear. What I'm experiencing is somewhere between 'annoying' and 'ouch', and it's mainly in my hands but also upper back, occasionally in my feet, and sometimes my right hip. Is this just "old age" or is there something I should be doing so I can be m..."

r/AskOldPeople · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/iygymp/how_much_joint_pain_is_thats_just_life_and_how/

Doctors, Medicare and insurance — 13

"I'm 85.....live alone.....eat peanut butter out of the jar.....will wear same clothes for 3-4 days in a row if they are still clean....walk about 2 miles a day....don't have cable so no ridiculous tv blaring....work a sudoku and wordle everyday...am on NO prescriptions! And have an attitude of gratitude every day!! 😊 😊 "

YouTube · 10 Things To Avoid When Living Alone as an Older Person (That No One Talks About · 421 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WHKQTdea1eY&lc=UgxdJYALzb8Mv3nawpN4AaABAg>

"Sure. When it comes to small aches and pains, the common cold, a pulled muscle I probably will just tough it out and wait to see if I get better. I usually do. Or it is something that is just not going to 'get better' like an arthritic knee. I live with it. HOWEVER, when it comes to long term, lingering symptoms, and mystery illnesses, I do NOT let the medical profession push me around. They don't always know what they are talking about. Case in point. I have had symptoms for years...like 10 or 15 years. (I won't go into the gory details unless someone asks me) I lost a great deal of weight over the last 5 years of the symptoms. Got really thin no matter what I ate, which was nice for a while..."

r/AskOldPeople · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/kbsoak/do_you_just_get_to_the_point_where_you_quit/gfke3fl/

"I'm 66- my mother just passed away at 89. Fortunately I was retired and have great siblings. I am retired, so had the time. Up until early this year she lived independently- I did pay for a housekeeper to come in once a week . I am about 4 hours away and made regular trips to help with filing and bill paying, I had just gotten the last of her bills in auto pay when she had a respiratory arrest and went to the hospital. From there to rehab - planning to move to assisted living, but she never made it:(. I hate to say it- but her rapid decline was a blessing- she went back to hospital and said, I don't want to do this anymore ". My sister asked if she wanted to go to hospice and she said yes. s..."

r/AskOldPeople · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1u2pkzt/are_any_fellow_old_people_here_caregiving_even/or9pohh/

The quiet, lonely house — 10

"I'm 85.....live alone.....eat peanut butter out of the jar.....will wear same clothes for 3-4 days in a row if they are still clean....walk about 2 miles a day....don't have cable so no ridiculous tv blaring....work a sudoku and wordle everyday...am on NO prescriptions! And have an attitude of gratitude every day!! 😊 😊 "

YouTube · 10 Things To Avoid When Living Alone as an Older Person (That No One Talks About · 421 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WHKQTdea1eY&lc=UgxdJYALzb8Mv3nawpN4AaABAg>

"After 25 years of marriage my ex and I finally called it quits. The last 10 years of my marriage were so lonely and miserable. After the divorce I went online and started to date. Did that for a couple of years. Met someone. He and I dated for 5 years. Married last year (just a quiet covid lockdown virtual wedding!). My husband and I both never thought we'd find someone. Both of us are so happy now."

r/AskOldPeople · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/oo31u6/divorced_and_widowed_seniors_please_tell_us_your/h5w87t4/

"I moved to a 55 and older independent living building in a new city after retiring at age 68. I love how much it has simplified my life, and the social interaction of activities and one meal a day in the dining room works for me even though I am a fairly quiet person. I was tired of living alone after being widowed 8 years. The main downside is that my building gets a lot of people who don't want to admit they are ready for assisted living or who have mental health issues. I think there is more of that here than in most 55+ with activities places as my place is less expensive than most of the others that aren't subsidized. My daughter is very happy that I downsized from a house to an aptme..."

r/retirement · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1li3qaj/considering_55_condo_but_something_feels_off_64m/mzll1hd/

Phones, technology, scam calls — 7

"I lost my temper today and I'm ashamed of myself For the last 20 years I've prided myself on always keeping a level head, not getting too emotional, sit back and think things through before I react. A little bit of backstory here. My dad (88) collapsed about 3 months ago and had to be rushed to the hospital. When they did his diagnosis the only hospital that had room was two hours away and they SUCK at keeping families posted. For every update I actually got it took me hours just trying to get to the right person to get info. They sent him home twice only to go majorly downhill twice and we had to send him back. Finally they put him in a rehab hospital for a couple of weeks and I got him hom..."

r/AgingParents · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dehem4/i_lost_my_temper_today_and_im_ashamed_of_myself/

"56 yo male widowed 2 years. Zero actual luck. A lot of hookers and pretenders who get really angry when I don't play into whatever scam they are pitching. I was with my wife for 35 years and truly don't understand modern dating."

r/AskOldPeople · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/oo31u6/divorced_and_widowed_seniors_please_tell_us_your/h5w412q/

"How did you meet your significant other? What dating advice would you give to a young man in their 20s? I hate dating apps and online dating. It's superficial and fake. Anyway, I'm in the real world now working as a corporate lawyer for a large law firm in NYC. All my time is spent on work, and a part of me is afraid that I'll grow old and die alone and stay at this job for the rest of my life. People my age say that with covid and intense work schedules, online dating is the way to go. Idk, maybe I'm just scared of the future and ending up alone? What advice would you give for me?"

r/AskOldPeople · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/r8czmn/how_did_you_meet_your_significant_other_what/

7. What they have tried

Theme	Documents
Physical therapy and exercise	39
Walker, cane, rollator	19

Downsized, or moved closer to the kids	19
Hearing aids	14
A lodger, roommate or friend nearby	12
Moved to a 55+, independent living or retirement community	10

Physical therapy and exercise — 39

"Here's my story after four years I retired four years ago at age 62 on a Friday and the next Monday I started a PT job working two days a week that has to do with my passion (golf). I had a pretty high stressed job, so it's nice not having to answer emails, texts and phone calls 24/7. I could never not do anything and I never have to look for things to do. I always have a to do list, whether it's my list or my wife's honey do list. She still works FT, so I've picked up most of the household chores. I love to cook, and I've expanded my repertoire, so we eat in most nights. At the most, we might go to our favorite place on Saturday night if we are in town. Not only have we cut down on our goin..."

r/retirement · 905 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1lft0j3/heres_my_story_after_four_years/

"What are your crazy routines in the morning, before bed, or leaving the house? As I (71m) age, my routines get more eccentric. "It's to be comfortable," I tell myself, but really?" At 5:30 a.m. I kiss my sleeping wife and get out of bed without wrenching my back. I think, "I am alive and nothing hurts." Once I take my pills, I carefully navigate the stairs to the kitchen. I make coffee, microwave my back pillow, and place a mug of coffee on my wife's night stand. After some Reddit and NYT, I take a hot bath (105 F water temp measured by my laser thermometer gun). This is a required habit to soothe my muscles. Afterwards, I put on my gym clothes. After breakfast, I stretch before I drive to t..."

r/retirement · 243 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1ufbdva/what_are_your_crazy_routines_in_the_morning/

"I'm a 68-year-old man, and I also had this problem. I found a solution, but it's not an easy fix. First, I started getting daily exercise. I do strength training on alternating days with cardio. I don't do anything strenuous. Easy repetitions on a Total Gym alternating days with 30 mins of a brisk walk. It took care of my minor aches and pains and allowed me to sleep through the night. Second (and this was the hardest), I quit eating after dinner and for the rest of the night. Nothing by mouth after dinner, except water and meds, and no alcohol or weed. I'm not saying it will work for everybody, but it worked for me. Good luck."

r/over60 · 187 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1rmklab/hi_over_60_ladies_im_so_sick_of_waking_up_in_the/o9060st/

Walker, cane, rollator — 19

"Please know that it is NOT "all" determined by how you take care of yourself. Don't fall for the ableism that says everyone with health issues is to blame because they "didn't take care of themselves". I developed a serious autoimmune disorder at age 20. It was not my "fault" for not taking care of myself. Now I have more autoimmune conditions as they "like to run in packs" per the immunologists. And I nearly died in a serious car accident. So yes, I use a cane, and yes, I am unable to climb a mountain with a loaded pack. And NOT because I "didn't take care of myself". And I exercise regularly and eat better than almost anyone else I know. If I didn't, I'd be in worse shape. I am still livin..."

r/AskOldPeople · 60 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1b0wf0w/are_we_all_gonna_need_help_as_we_age/ksawm8x/

"As a 66 year old female who is recuperating from a very recent post fall ankle surgery, this speaks to me. I experienced a simple misstep (so you might think) that resulted in a serious fracture. I've dealt with osteoarthritis and other chronic age related changes. This event has changed my life. I am unable to walk and will be out of work for three at least months. I use a wheelchair and rely on my spouse for assistance. I pray it's temporary. All to say it is humbling and frustrating when independence is lost. I agree with what you are saying. I'm working on acceptance and challenging unhelpful thoughts. Accepting help. I'm trying to not diminish my view of me. Your mother comes from a gen..."

r/Aging · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Aging/comments/1udg8tk/if_i_had_any_advice_to_give_to_people_about_aging/otbi6eb/

"I have been using rollators for years. Seat comfort is important! If yours is comfortable or hard as a rock, Amazon now sells cushions that you can add to the rollator. It makes a huge difference. I find rollators that come with a basket that fits below the front of the seat makes it easier to haul things or to shop. Pouches do offer more security though. I prefer rollators that have a firm seat over ones that are just a strap. I use my rollator to haul all sorts of stuff around . Firm seat makes hauling things much easier. The rollators with a strap seat may be much lighter, which is important if you will getting in and out of a vehicle . I am over 80 and have bad shoulders but usually can ..."

YouTube · 6 Things Everyone Must Know Before Buying a Walker with a Seat · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pcJQrEF-ATg&lc=UgxUmLn2ROMHjlbGpMN4AaABAq>

Downsized, or moved closer to the kids — 19

"I bought my condo at 63 in a 55 and over community. I love it, no outside maintenance and all on one level. When I moved in I was on the young side of average but I keep getting older and new owners are getting younger so I'm comfortably moving towards the average age of residents."

r/AskOldPeople · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1jmrhbx/any_of_you_good_folks_in_55_communities/mke0pmt/

"My husband's parents never downsized or gave anything away, and dealing with 43 years of stuff was a NIGHTMARE. Especially since they lived on the other side of the country from us, so we had to fly back and forth over and over and over. It was painful for us to do and for them to see. Now my husband and I are in our 50's and we are committed to not putting our children through all that. We downsized from a five bedroom, three story house to a two bedroom condo, and weeded out 95% of what we don't need. We do have a storage space for the kids "precious things" that they were storing in our basement, and a few other random things, but when we die, it won't be too hard to get things in order."

r/AskOldPeople · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/txqiuu/how_have_you_downsized_your_life_as_you_get_older/i3o05n0/

"We moved to be near our adult daughter when she had children. We were retired, but we also brought along my dad, then 97 now 103. (!) I was the one who pushed for it, and I had many reasons. First, I personally could not have had the relationship I wanted with my grandchildren seeing them occasionally. I wanted to be part of the fabric of their lives. Second, I wanted my dad to be able to know them. And I knew he'd eventually require more care, and that would prove difficult/impossible if I was always visiting kids. Third, I wanted us—a healthy couple in our 60s—to downsize and be somewhere where we could age in place and be turnkey when we traveled. Finally, I wanted to escape the town I'd ..."

r/retirement · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1eqg8k2/to_follow_or_not_to_follow_kids_in_retirement/lhris6k/

Hearing aids — 14

"No, it is not!! I'm in my eighties, did a lot of woodworking, grouse and quail shooting without ear protection when I was younger and now have hearing difficulty. I don't watch tv (prefer to read) but I use hearing aids as a courtesy to others. It is rude, selfish and arrogant to expect others to put up with infirmities that can be ameliorated."

r/AgingParents · 141 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q1gnyn/cant_take_it_anymore/nx6k1ba/

"Review of Apple AirPods Pro 3 as hearing aids Like many of us old folks, I have age-related hearing loss, with a sharp drop-off of hearing ability above 1 kHz. I've been using the hearing assistance features of Apple AirPods Pro 2 (APP2) with my iPhone 16 Pro Max to help me with speech comprehension and music enjoyment. The APP2 has helped quite a bit with speech in quiet surroundings, but not noisy ones. It has enough amplification to hear all the keys of the piano (up to 4186 Hz), and fundamental notes of most other musical instruments. I've been delighted with the improvement in music sound quality. Outdoors I can hear a few more birds than with my unaided ears, though not nearly as many ..."

r/HearingAids · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/HearingAids/comments/1nmqxqe/review_of_apple_airpods_pro_3_as_hearing_aids/

"I'm 77 and I've been wearing hearing aids for 5 months. I watched my mother in law and my own mother refuse hearing aids because of vanity. When I got to the point that I was unable to understand what was being said in meetings I scheduled a hearing test and am grateful that hearing aids are available. To refuse hearing aids is to give up on life now. And since cognitive function results you're giving up on the rest of your life. Too sad."

YouTube · How to Reduce the Risk of Dementia - Part 2 Hearing Loss · 17 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1OQcrEpy-Pw&lc=Ugw7IAL7tMO154mjVgh4AaABAg>

A lodger, roommate or friend nearby — 12

"I just moved out of a retirement village I lived in for two months and discovered I hate living on somebody else's schedule. Dinner at 4:45? I am 84-old enough to be your mother. Make a move, girl. I bought a house that I plan to live in until I die, hiring help when necessary and sharing life with my caring partner. I figure I'll save a fortune. Those places are enormously expensive, and I was paying for care I didn't need."

YouTube · I Moved to a Retirement Community and Now I Regret It! · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Egdvs0TPrIA&lc=UgyQUGzvc6zeR5-HEhx4AaABAg>

"Mid 50s isn't dead. You have another 30+ years ahead of you if your dad is any indication. I recommend getting out and mixing it up a bit. It might sound corny but volunteer work is a great way to meet people with like minds. But the decluttering is super cleansing as well. My wife and I retired and sold our house right at the beginning of the pandemic. We got rid of at least 80% of what we owned and now live in a 1000 sf lake cabin that we built over the past year and a half (southern Missouri). I'm 66, just got two hip replacements paid for by Medicare and have never been happier. I'm also spending October and November traveling through the Balkans this year. Not boring. The point is that ..."

r/retirement · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1fd8ew1/what_my_dad_is_teaching_me_about_retirement/lmi0det/

"That's what I was thinking putting a camera in their room if they did maybe they treat them like the king and queen I bet that place is closed down now I had to live in one for a while after I got out of the hospital they charged me \$5000.00 monthly but I have to I had one worker I didn't care for my physical therapy lady told me to get a nurses aid to help me go to the bathroom I'm saying in the wheelchair to the bathroom cuz it was hard to get over the bump in the bathroom and she was arguing with me she just didn't want to do anything she wouldn't let me talk she just kept on you can do it I kept saying I couldn't I told on her I told them I didn't want her in my room but I had to have a ..."

YouTube · Life and Death in Assisted Living (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j5wxhOslUfE&lc=Ugxc1fZ70yjW-vM6kod4AaABAq_9dQUNetv-e99dg37MTVn5g

Moved to a 55+, independent living or retirement community — 10

"Moved into one two years ago. No place is perfect, but this has been better than we ever imagined. I will say don't wait to move to one. Too many people who try to live here waited too long and, then, they are too sick or the spouse dies and then they do not get the full benefit of living here. It's not the "home". Hopefully, you start in "independent living" and not assisted living. We like the people who live here (we found our tribe) and the stated values of the organization you see enacted daily. So, I ask you, "not ready" for what? We moved to an independent living apartment, well, rather, we have sort of an attached patio home with a garage and our own little garden space. House mainte..."

r/retirement · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1qpgzc1/anyone_planning_for_a_future_move_to_a_ccrc/o2pnud8/

"I moved to a 55 and older independent living building in a new city after retiring at age 68. I love how much it has simplified my life, and the social interaction of activities and one meal a day in the dining room works for me even though I am a fairly quiet person. I was tired of living alone after being widowed 8 years. The main downside is that my building gets a lot of people who don't want to admit they are ready for assisted living or who have mental health issues. I think there is more of that here than in most 55+ with activities places as my place is less expensive than most of the others that aren't subsidized. My daughter is very happy that I downsized from a house to an apartme..."

r/retirement · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1li3qaj/considering_55_condo_but_something_feels_off_64m/mzll1hd/

"I moved into a 55+ condo a few months ago. Yes, I'm at the younger end of the age spectrum here but there are many active, healthy people my age. My neighbors are great! It's a modest, older complex. I wanted to move back to the city and never do yard work again. I feel safe here. The price was right and it has the amenities I wanted plus a pool. You'd never know it was 55+ unless you hang out at the clubhouse or attend the pot lucks and bus excursions. I can walk to restaurants and the library. There's bus service to the grocery store. There are puzzles, books, DVDs and a food pantry for those who need a little help. I love it!"

r/AskOldPeople · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1jmrhbx/any_of_you_good_folks_in_55_communities/mke9or9/

8. What they wish existed

Theme	Documents
I wish I had done it sooner	14
Company, not care	12
The best thing I ever did	6

I wish I had done it sooner — 14

"Many times every day. I would love to talk and or text with them every day. But I don't, because I know that adult kids have their own lives. I call them about once a week. It can be painful to want to see them so much more than they want to see me -It feels a bit like an unrequited love - but I don't tell them that, because I vividly remember being their age. I loved my parents, but found it annoying to spend much time with them. Not proud of that, and wish I had understood then how very much it meant to them when I did spend time with them. I wish I had talked with them about their lives more. My kids call me when they have a problem and trust me to talk them down when they're upset, and t..."

r/AskOldPeople · 289 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1m7s8ds/how_often_do_you_think_of_your_grown_kids/n4u1i9z/

"When I was younger i maxed my pretax 401k and put nothing in the Roth. My attitude always was a) that I will probably be in a lower tax bracket in retirement and b) if I'm in a higher bracket in retirement that's a problem of abundance, not poverty. Now that I am here (66 y.o.) I wish I had contributed more to Roth to allow my investments to keep growing tax free!"

r/retirement · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1tim07y/whoopsies_learnings_from_regrettable_decisions_in/omyv94t/

"I had a Dentist break my jaw , followed by a plate being put in my face , I've had some horrible crazy things happen BUT NOTHING!!!! Compared to getting shingles on my scalp and near my eye. It is straight up evil and will try to destroy you. It's a year later and I'm still dealing with nerve damage to my eye and forehead. I honestly don't think I'll ever get my eyesight back to normal. I wish I had gotten the Shingles vaccine ."

r/AskOldPeople · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1j8t2rf/what_was_the_most_debilitating_health_issue_you/mh7uwb/

Company, not care — 12

"Things are definitely worse from where I stand (US / UK citizen living in UK). I'm glad I'm old, and I fear for my young relatives and friends."

r/AskOldPeople · 53 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/13xifr5/losing_hope_for_the_future_is_it_a_normal_part_of/jmhchix/

"I think this is an excellent idea. You can see it coming at you like a train down the tracks...if you are aware and have dealt with it before. I am. I cared for my mom who died at 72 after 10 years of early onset Alzheimer's, and for my younger brother who had AIDS-related dementia before his death. Also looked after my father who died at 88 and stepmom who passed at 86 and both had age-related issues. So, now I'm 77 and seeing some of the early signs. Would be nice to have someone to talk to."

Mayo Clinic Connect · 33 reactions · <https://connect.mayoclinic.org/comment/932828/>

"I wish my kids would visit more without me asking. I'm 68 and don't really need much, but spontaneous visits, just a day or 2 would be nice."

r/AskOldPeople · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/16jdw17/how_do_we_help_you_for_the_70_crowd/k0pngtw/

The best thing I ever did — 6

"I've downsized twice. Due to the untimely death of my husband when he was 39 yrs. old. I have no mortgage which was key in being able to retire early. I gave away my car. I ride a bike. I haven't had cable or a TV since 2011. I basically turned my back on being a consumer and accumulating things. I guess I'm a minimalist. I live in a co-op with lots of really great people in a nice community where expenses are shared and maintenance is paid every month including taxes and water. It was the best decision I ever made and we have monthly trips and events. We even have miniature golf! You have to pay cash for your home and you get a "share" in the co-op, so you really don't own your home, which m..."

r/AskOldPeople · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/txqiuv/how_have_you_downsized_your_life_as_you_got_older/3nqvbo/

"I'm 60, and I take no medications. I started jogging in high school and continued most of my life, until recently when my knees bothered me. But my main love all my life has been backpacking, usually one long trip of 5-7 weeks and one short trip of about 3 weeks per year, although none while pregnant with each of my 4 kids or for a year after giving birth in order to breastfeed. I became a vegetarian in college. I homeschooled my kids, and since I wanted them to be fit, I ate better and took care of myself more than I would have on my own: we got up to lift weights and take walks/runs/bike rides most days of the week. I took each of them backpacking each season, too, and we had a lot of dayh..."

r/AskOldPeople · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/bynf1z/people_over_60_on_reddit_who_have_no_health/eqjzywq/

"What a wonderful story and loved hearing every word. I'm 77 and I'm so glad I got to hear your story. Thank you"

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 19 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLG_Mbc&lc=Ugz-iT3ioVohjw2UKIJ4AaABAq

9. Desired Outcomes

Theme	Documents
Stay in my own home as long as I can	37
Stay healthy and moving	29
People around me	26
Keep my independence	12
Money that lasts	6

Stay in my own home as long as I can — 37

"I am 94 years old and still live alone . Not in a stick and bricks home but in 28' motorhome that I still drive and move every 2-3 weeks from one campground to another. I locate, back into my site, hook up the electric, water and sewer. Then set my jacks, extend my slide out and rearrange the inside from travel mode to stay put mode. I also work on listing jewelry on eBay and make the phone calls on my list of things to take care of. So far I can manage it all but some chores are difficult. One park is my favorite and my home base. I have friends in the park and Rv techs to call for repairs and fixes. I have my groceries delivered. I do not want to live with my daughters and they did tell me ..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 360 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLG_Mbc&lc=Ugx6fGhU40zdvpPcx9V4AaABAq

"This is the one thing that should never happen in a free country, grown children forcing their parents into a nursing home, many times to steal their parents home and belongings. Fortunately for me my grown children are all very well off. Executives etc. Also I do not live near them, we only communicate on Bdays or Christmas. I am in my 80's and I live alone in the boondocks. I love it and no one is going to put me away. I want to be left alone to die here in peace. I am armed and I will never leave my home without a fight. America is unique in that most countries the children care for the parents till death. In America nursing homes are a multi billion dollar enterprise that try to push old..."

YouTube · Avoid the Nursing Home With This Simple Plan · 148 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YgT0aiJXA4k&lc=Ugx4GQjBZKvEsHJkFPx4AaABAg>

"I am 72 almost 73. I plan to stay in my single family two story home as long as I can. Doing stairs is doable. Those glossy brochures lie. I know in my soul I am meant to stay in my home. I have lived here 30 years. I am making a few changes. I am simplifying my yard work. Making sure I maintain my home. I love the peace in my community. And the mature trees."

YouTube · I Moved to a Retirement Community and Now I Regret It! · 114 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Egdvs0TPrIA&lc=Ugyi1KIEChKpV_sbufx4AaABAg

Stay healthy and moving — 29

"I went from being a caregiver to my husband for three years until he passed away. That same year, I became my parents caregiver. My mother passed away seven months later. I took care of my dad 24/7 for the last nine years until he passed away, November of last year at the age of 99. Now, this is my time to do what I want. Sleep when I want, eat when I want and I truly love being alone now. I'm now 70 years old with some health issues, so, I plan on living my final days as I want to."

YouTube · 10 Things To Avoid When Living Alone as an Older Person (That No One Talks About) · 182 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WHKQTdea1eY&lc=UgyUA3NnV9X3gJkCU514AaABAg>

"I'm 66 and working on building up my strength especially lower body. I want to be strong into my 80s. I want to be able to walk wherever I want to go."

YouTube · What 92 Years Taught Me: 10 Lessons I Wish I'd Learned in My 50s & 60s · 50 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vVk2rfkaD5w&lc=Ugxt7BgJ1CjTI00h7k14AaABAg>

"I am a 75 year old woman who does wear hearing aids. I am so grateful for them as they have improved my ability to socialize because I can actually hear (most) conversations now and engage. They don't solve every issue for everyone though. There are some vocal tones that I just still can't hear well. And even if I increase the volume on the hearing aids, it is still impossible for me to understand low soft voices. I would argue though that even the less expensive hearing aids are too costly for many people. Since there is a known risk of dementia with hearing loss, I would like to see our health care cover more of the costs for low income citizens. And, as usual, I found this a helpful video..."

YouTube · How to Reduce the Risk of Dementia - Part 2 Hearing Loss · 45 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1OQCrEpy-Pw&lc=UgzU6IN8YJfyQYOhWn94AaABAg>

People around me — 26

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone..

[[https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/)]
([https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/))

First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and cha..."

r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i have reached my limit i want to die update shes/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/)

"I'm 68 and live in a senior apartment complex. Ever since one of my neighbors was found deceased only because a horrible odor was radiating from her apartment, this has been a topic of concern among many residents. Many of us are pet owners and we do have a concern about the welfare of our fur babies after our passing. I've never heard of the snug app before, and I don't think any of my neighbors know about it, or it would have been mentioned. So this thread has been helpful in that regard. And I plan to share what I've learned with my neighbors."

r/AskOldPeople · 146 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1nzasj3/im 65 and i live with just my dog i often wonder/ni14qsm/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1nzasj3/im_65_and_i_live_with_just_my_dog_i_often_wonder/ni14qsm/)

"I am 72 almost 73. I plan to stay in my single family two story home as long as I can. Doing stairs is doable. Those glossy brochures lie. I know in my soul I am meant to stay in my home. I have lived here 30 years. I am making a few changes. I am simplifying my yard work. Making sure I maintain my home. I love the peace in my community. And the mature trees."

YouTube · I Moved to a Retirement Community and Now I Regret It! · 114 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Egdvs0TPrIA&lc=Ugyi1KIEChKpV_sbux4AaABAq

Keep my independence — 12

"Sigh ❤️ My husband died 3 days before our 46th wedding anniversary. He was 67 and now here I am living alone. Grateful I have children and grandchildren, but they have their own journey and lives and I am trying to be as independent as I can for as long as I can."

r/LivingAlone · 90 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/LivingAlone/comments/1wb1byj/final_journey_of_life/p8mprst/

"I believe that many of us like the idea of being self sufficient and independent to what ever extent we can, and this is particularly true as we age. At my age of 84 with a few physical problems I can speak with authority about this. I sincerely believe that my basic computer knowledge and use along with a I Phone has enabled me to maintain my independence far better than most of my peer group and maintain a good quality of life. No one had to force me to give up driving two years ago, I made that decision my self and sold my car in 24 hours for a good price and then called and cancelled my auto insurance and started using UBER. I can go where ever I want when ever I want and not be DEPENDEN..."

AARP Community · INDEPENDENCE & GROWING OLD · 17 likes · <https://community.aarp.org/leisure-lifestyle-13/independence-growing-old-1037>

"Senior Safety Advice, old age comes to everyone. No, disrespect to you but you appear to be on that road too. I've listened to what you have to say and discovered most of it was directed to the care givers who are burdened with us old folks. I am seventy and I fall from time to time but manage to get up but even if I didn't I would rather die on my own living room floor than in a bed or on the floor in a nursing home. I am as social as I want to be since we live in the age of communication with a vast array of modes of communication to choose from. There is a difference between being alone and being lonely. Women spend most of our adult lives caring for others, but if we are lucky sometimes ..."

YouTube · Can Your Senior Parent Continue To Live Alone? 10 Signs To Look For · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E41ccWr1uEY&lc=UgxVj8jQxpoz_8N9a-d4AaABAq

Money that lasts — 6

"I'm 60, and I take no medications. I started jogging in high school and continued most of my life, until recently when my knees bothered me. But my main love all my life has been backpacking, usually one long trip of 5-7 weeks and one short trip of about 3 weeks per year, although none while pregnant with each of my 4 kids or for a year after giving birth in order to breastfeed. I became a vegetarian in college. I homeschooled my kids, and since I wanted them to be fit, I ate better and took care of myself more than I would have on my own: we got up to lift weights and take walks/runs/bike rides most days of the week. I took each of them backpacking each season, too, and we had a lot of dayh..."

r/AskOldPeople · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/bynf1z/people_over_60_on_reddit_who_have_no_health/eqjzyw_c/

"This is probably a very American Healthcare influenced answer, but my real anxiety isn't leaving enough for my kids, it's leaving them with medical debt from our insanely expensive palliative care environment. I WANT to enjoy my money now, but I also watched my grandparents go into a retirement community with literal millions only to watch them be milked down to zero when they were relatively low need. You should enjoy your earned wealth while you're here, but the nagging fear of destitution in old age and becoming a burden on children is what drives me to hoard."

r/AskOldPeople · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/10ck8zk/marie_osmond_says_she_is_not_giving_her_8/j4ir3s9/

"Oh my goodness, I had this conversation yesterday because I am downsizing and leaving my beautiful home of 20 years 🥹. Why? I'm relocating to live in the same city as my daughter and her family. I have no family where I am currently living as my parents passed away 4 years ago. I'm 69 and now have grandchildren living elsewhere. I want to be part of my family but my home can't move with me and the one I can afford is half the size - literally. So downsizing is something I am doing by choice, but freaking out about the downsides which I am already well aware of."

YouTube · The Shocking Truth About DOWNSIZING (No One Talks About) · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mCg4TOcV-fw&lc=UgxrsHwmZfs67jA39x54AaABAq>

10. A typical day

Theme	Documents
Waking up and the morning routine	131
Walking and exercise	106
Nights: sleep, the bathroom, waking at 3am	105
Evenings alone and the quiet	44

TV, reading, puzzles, the phone	33
Pills, pain and the body first thing	29
Chores, shopping and errands	28
Church, friends, the senior center	25
Appointments and doctors	9

Waking up and the morning routine — 131

"Retired, Living Alone I'm a 72-year-old introvert and live alone in a small studio with my elderly rescue dog. I have a single bed, a single chair, a tiny but functional kitchen, and a little porch where I can drink tea and watch the birds every morning. It's mine all mine. Life is perfect, at last!"

r/LivingAlone · 12,076 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/LivingAlone/comments/1rlnk5m/retired_living_alone/

"I am 72 and have lived alone since I divorced mt husband at 37. I wake every morning grateful for my solitude."

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 1,540 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=UgziDL6D9qJBYYfl_eJ4AaABAq

"Did not expect the days to fly by so fast I (66m) retired officially March 1. I had been on family leave since December to care for my dying son at a hospice. I basically lived there. He was a firefighter who fell in line of duty. To experience something like this, brings in many changes in thinking. It's like a crucible that burns away things that don't matter anymore. The day before he passed, I called work and informed them I would not be coming back. I gave them a month's notice and spent time tying off loose ends. Retirement is pretty awesome, I have lots of interests and hobbies to keep me busy, design & make things, I have a vintage car which always needs my time, astronomy, travel, a..."

r/retirement · 591 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1bzvdxr/did_not_expect_the_days_to_fly_by_so_fast/

Walking and exercise — 106

"I'm sorry you're sad and bummed out, but I swear, your video was the only thing that made me smile today. It's wonderful to find an honest, normal person online. If it makes you feel any better, I'm in my seventies, living in a suburb, and it's not much different here. When I walk through my neighborhood, most days I don't see a living soul. Cars are in driveways, but no one is outside. I'm lucky to see a dog. It's like living in an episode of The Twilight Zone. Anyway, I sure did enjoy listening to your descriptions. Wish you lived down the street; I think you're a hoot."

YouTube · I Moved to a Retirement Community and Now I Regret It! · 403 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Egds0TPrIA&lc=UgzXhQQ6ntqmrKMDZvl4AaABAq>

"Finding Meaning in Retirement : Health, gardening, and relocation I have been retired now for four years and I thought I would share my experience which may, or may not, relate to you. This is mostly my story and lessons that I learned. It's a lengthy essay so I will break it up into a couple of different posts.. This is the first part, covering health, gardening, and relocation. # Health I'll start here because it's arguably the most important. When you retire, it's like a starter gun going off in a race toward your death. At whatever age you retire, you immediately calculate, *How much time do I have left?* It's like your doctor just gave you a terminal diagnosis. How long do I have, doc? ..."

r/retirement · 402 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1mq7tcq/finding_meaning_in_retirement_health_gardening/

"Just Feeling Sad Most of the Time Im 65 live alone. My child is married in another state. I have family and friends locally. I retired at 62. My health is good. I exercise daily. I also quit drinking a year ago and naturally stopped frequenting the bars and restaurants I was drinking at. I feel better and healthier plus its safer to be sober. I was content the first couple years after retiring. The last year not so much. Even broke off a relationship. Not sure what makes me happy anymore. Im doing pretty much the same things I have been doing, other than the drinking and eating. But that was my main social activity. Have noticed friends and acquaintances passing on. Many at this point are wi..."

r/over60 · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1q90k4t/just_feeling_sad_most_of_the_time/

Nights: sleep, the bathroom, waking at 3am — 105

"Seeing My Parents in Their 70s Has Changed How I View Aging I'm not over 60, but my parents are both in their 70s — and seeing how they navigate life at this stage has truly opened my eyes. From health shifts to sleep changes, and even how they stay mentally sharp and find meaning in daily routines... it's been humbling. It's made me want to understand more about this chapter of life, and do something meaningful in response. Thanks for letting someone younger be a part of this space."

r/over60 · 1,296 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1jzq3ts/seeing_my_parents_in_their_70s_has_changed_how_i/

"Hi over 60 ladies. I'm so sick of waking up in the middle of the night and lying here for hours, unable to get back to sleep., then feeling so tired all day .I've tried herbal remedies like Valerian, Magnesium, Melatonin , I'm exhausted every day 😞 Help please? Hi , I'm 65 and wonder if others have this problem too. ? I fall asleep exhausted at night, then wake up around 2am , well tonight it was almost midnight, and now it's 4.30 am and here I am still awake. I might eventually fall asleep, then when I get up later , I feel like a zombie most of the day. So tired and over it 😞 "

r/over60 · 254 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1rmklab/hi_over_60_ladies_im_so_sick_of_waking_up_in_the/

"What are your crazy routines in the morning, before bed, or leaving the house? As I (71m) age, my routines get more eccentric. "It's to be comfortable," I tell myself, but really?" At 5:30 a.m. I kiss my sleeping wife and get out of bed without wrenching my back. I think, "I am alive and nothing hurts." Once I take my pills, I carefully navigate the stairs to the kitchen. I make coffee, microwave my back pillow, and place a mug of coffee on my wife's night stand. After some Reddit and NYT, I take a hot bath (105 F water temp measured by my laser thermometer gun). This is a required habit to soothe my muscles. Afterwards, I put on my gym clothes. After breakfast, I stretch before I drive to t..."

r/retirement · 243 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1ufbdva/what_are_your_crazy_routines_in_the_morning/

Evenings alone and the quiet — 44

"Did not expect the days to fly by so fast I (66m) retired officially March 1. I had been on family leave since December to care for my dying son at a hospice. I basically lived there. He was a firefighter who fell in line of duty. To experience something like this, brings in many changes in thinking. It's like a crucible that burns away things that don't matter anymore. The day before he passed, I called work and informed them I would not be coming back. I gave them a month's notice and spent time tying off loose ends. Retirement is pretty awesome, I have lots of interests and hobbies to keep me busy, design & make things, I have a vintage car which always needs my time, astronomy, travel, a..."

r/retirement · 591 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1bzvdxr/did_not_expect_the_days_to_fly_by_so_fast/

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone..

[[https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/)]
([https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/))

First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and cha..."

r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i have reached my limit i want to die update shes/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/)

"I'm a 82 years old, my husband passed away , I live in Florida alone, my children live in another state, with the grace of God, I go to church every morning then go with my friend shopping and on Sunday I have another church with another good Godly friends, rest of the day praying and listening to preaching, most of the day with the lord and he takes care of me, Glory to our lord Jesus Christ, we can't do anything without him 🙏🙏 "

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 164 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLGMbc&lc=UgxuOAufJfFPMAUhVZ94AaABAq>

TV, reading, puzzles, the phone — 33

"Here's my story after four years I retired four years ago at age 62 on a Friday and the next Monday I started a PT job working two days a week that has to do with my passion (golf). I had a pretty high stressed job, so it's nice not having to answer emails, texts and phone calls 24/7. I could never not do anything and I never have to look for things to do. I always have a to do list, whether it's my list or my wife's honey do list. She still works FT, so I've picked up most of the household chores. I love to cook, and I've expanded my repertoire, so we eat in most nights. At the most, we might go to our favorite place on Saturday night if we are in town. Not only have we cut down on our goin..."

r/retirement · 905 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1ft0j3/heres_my_story_after_four_years/

"It so very very sad to see old persons so alone at the end of their life. I am LatinAmerican, our culture is family and friend oriented. We are always on the look out of our old family members. It is not well accepted socially to send the elderly to a home, unless it is absolutely necessary because of a specific family problem. I am a widow, I am 75 years old, when my husband passed away, immediately one of my children came to live with me. My son comes to lunch every sunday with his children or takes me out for lunch. When my mother became old, and she was very indipendent, I moved to an apartment in a building next to hers, she had the keys to my apartment, my husband and children loved it..."

YouTube · What does it feel like to be old and alone? · 126 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V5EsxU84ay4&lc=UgwgtJXtQQybSYF5Pq14AaABAq>

"Out of the Norm: Retiring on \$1300 a month? Apparently Possible. **So my band of cousins occasionally has Zoom calls. We are all now 55+, grew up together but now living around the country. There are some who never participate, one without kids and parents long deceased. One active cousin who is a retired social worker started to reach out to her more. The updates have been VERY interesting (and I have permission to share). This cousin has no pension and little in retirement accounts. Is on SS that she took at 62, around 1300 a month. Does not own a home. Low level worker her whole life, but always paid her bills and managed. Quiet, diligent.** Social work cousin confirmed the following:..."

r/retirement · 117 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/13hi5c8/out_of_the_norm_retiring_on_1300_a_month/

Pills, pain and the body first thing — 29

"Lesson Learned: You have to be YOUR OWN ADVOCATE with medical emergencies! Warning: Long post: 64M, Married, live in Southern CO. Retired. Learned a very painful lesson (literally) this week. I have a long history of knee issues, partially due to 23 years in the Army but also just people in my family have bad knees. I had had a couple of minor but annoying medical issues pop up earlier in the year. An abdominal hematoma that we don't know the cause of (my theory is too much ibuprofen from various aches and pains thinned my blood) and then a planned nasal surgery (sepotplasty) which I have to say is one of the most unpleasant experiences I've ever had. So after spending all day Wednesday chan..."

r/over60 · 246 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1tmw6zd/lesson_learned_you_have_to_be_your_own_advocate/

"If I sit for more than 15 minutes my joints rust. Then when I get up it is a serious of cracks, pops and serious pain for the first few minutes."

r/AskOldPeople · 196 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1kj5h9n/what_was_the_first_thing_you_noticed_about_your/mrk63l2/

"I'm gonna be 71 next week and so far I don't need any assistance BUT no matter how many times I tell my two granddaughters to stop they insist on either texting or calling me daily to remind me to take my meds. I remember. I'm not that forgetful yet, I love them both and their husbands too, what's his name and the other guy."

r/AskOldPeople · 96 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/16jdw17/how_do_we_help_you_for_the_70_crowd/k0p598l/

11. Ailments & needs

Condition (own voice)	Own	Spouse
Loneliness / isolation	137	5
Cancer	108	36
Depression / anxiety	102	3
Memory / dementia / MCI	90	19
Falls / balance / dizziness	87	0
Hearing loss	87	3
Arthritis / joint pain	83	0
Incontinence / bladder	68	1
Vision (macular degeneration, glaucoma, cataracts)	50	1
Heart (failure, AFib, attack, pacemaker)	48	10
Chronic pain	48	2
Diabetes	40	2
Mobility limits (can't walk far)	37	2
Back pain / stenosis / sciatica	35	0
Knee / hip replacement	33	0
Stroke / TIA	28	11
COPD / breathing / oxygen	23	4
Osteoporosis / fractures	21	0

Appetite / weight loss / swallowing	16	1
Neuropathy	15	0
Weakness / frailty / fatigue	13	1
Sleep problems	7	0
Parkinson's	6	8
Kidney disease / dialysis	4	0

Task they can no longer do alone	Documents
Driving / rides / appointments	55
Walking / getting around	52
Getting up / stairs / transfers	21
Meals / cooking / groceries	21
Help if I fall / at night	17
Yard / home repairs	15
Bathing / showering	13
Bills / paperwork / scams	7
Housework / laundry	5
Dressing	2
Medications	2
Company / someone to talk to	2

Loneliness / isolation

"I'm 70 years, living alone by choice and loving it. But I'm very young for my age and very healthy. I know how blessed I am. But I also feel for the elderly who are sad and lonely and have no one to care for them. I'm very active and that makes a huge difference. I'm real involved in emailing, texting, talking on the phone, and projects around the home. I've also been called to Christian service and am still very active with others, teaching and counseling and giving. My mom passed away this year..."

YouTube · What does it feel like to be old and alone? · 521 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V5EsxU84ay4&lc=UgxovloZDOZVDFKNVB4AaABAg>

"TV is my roommate? YouTube is my roommate. I'm lonely. I'm an 82 year old widow. I love learning new things. I love keeping youtube podcasts (such as this one) playing while I clean, cook, bathe, exercise. It makes me feel surrounded by a group of friendly people providing helpful advice or challenging debates. No, having constant conversations in my background makes me feel more alive and connected to the world. So-- here's to constant companions and end of loneliness. I do speak to human friend..."

YouTube · 10 Things To Avoid When Living Alone as an Older Person (That No One Talks About · 441 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W_HKQTdea1eY&lc=Ugyxp7ARwtN9xp-L-Z4AaABAg

Cancer

"65yr old Widow lost & no desire for life Who else feels life is over ? At 35 my 11 year-old was diagnosed with the brain tumor. She lived at Duke University for nine months. We were able to bring her home after surgery chemo and radiation. She lived for three years. She died of an infection from her G-tube three days after she turned 15, 12 years later, my husband coming home from work at Cape Canaveral in Florida Died on the interstate due to carelessness to another driver headed to the Dayton..."

r/over60 · 1,728 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1j3k5an/65yr_old_widow_lost_no_desire_for_life/

"Pulled the trigger at 60 - my choice, I have enough, had enough Hi Folks, giving back to this terrific community. I've answered a few posts and made various comments but mostly have been learning and anticipating. So I thought I would share a bit and answer any questions. I put in my notice last Friday a week, my last day is the 20th and I'm excited to get my last paycheck soon. At 60 it is a little early but I have done the work and feel confident I will be okay. I know 60 isn't that early but..."

r/retirement · 752 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1r5hp4m/pulled_the_trigger_at_60_my_choice_i_have_enough/

Depression / anxiety

"I did not expect this to happen to me in my 60s I'll be 64 in November. I've worked in corporate for 35 years. The greater part of my career was in management and I made a 6 figure salary with great benefits **in the latter years of my career**. Got laid off with a severance during COVID in 2020, after close to 20 years on the job. Haven't fully recovered from that, tbh. Since then, via networking, I was hired and laid off twice - by 2 different companies. Most recent layoff in July 2024. I fee..."

r/over60 · 1,271 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1jdxgx/i_did_not_expect_this_to_happen_to_me_in_my_60s/

"I can't thank you enough perfect timing. Lying in my bed scrolling YouTube. I've been in bed for the last two days partly because I wasn't well mainly because of depression.. watching your video I got up had a shower, listened and dance to music I will continue to go on and fight I'm 65 years old I have MS but I still have life"

YouTube · What 92 Years Taught Me: 10 Lessons I Wish I'd Learned in My 50s & 60s · 604 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vVk2rfkaD5w&lc=Ugw5_VBZyA91SLj1tZh4AaABAq

Memory / dementia / MCI

"Gene Hackman's death Infrequently, someone will inquire about who will care for the my husband and I in our dotage since we have no children. We are "Plan for the worst & hope for the best" types and we have recently moved from the farm to a town home all on one level and more easily accessible to services. We have no children. We are not parents. I do hear a certain amount of venting about children from our friends who are parents and grandparents. Kids who don't call, hurt feelings and the li..."

r/over60 · 899 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1j77lgw/gene_hackmans_death/

"WHAT IS YOUR PURPOSE AT 69 YEARS OLD? (TLDR: A 2-minute stream of consciousness about aging, friendship, and happiness). Like a blurry-eyed man standing in front of a mirror, I lived most of my life without much introspection. Could I attribute the condition to my forty-year slog on the corporate hamster wheel? Standing in the long shadow of time, I see deep creases on my face. Clarity takes shape like the perfect aperture setting on a camera. When I awoke, I rolled over, wanting closeness. My w..."

r/retirement · 638 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1bp306p/what_is_your_purpose_at_69_years_old/

Falls / balance / dizziness

"Exercising over 60 is totally worth it! I don't enjoy exercising, but at 62, I do it to maintain my mobility and it paid off in a big way yesterday. On the return trip, refilling the chicken water, some rocks rolled under my foot, and I fell. Since I was carrying 2 gallons of water, I couldn't use my hands to break my fall. I went to my knees and elbows, on (small) rocks no less. Here's the great part: aside from having a skinned knee and some very minor bruising like an 8 y/o, I was uninjured...."

r/over60 · 544 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1nrcnlp/exercising_over_60_is_totally_worth_it/

"Carotid Artery check A friend was having problems with occasional lightheaded feelings. His doctor recommended an ultrasound of his carotid artery and found that he had significant plaque buildup. This can also lead to a stroke. I asked my doctor if I could get one and she said insurance wouldn't cover it unless I had related symptoms. I told her "okay, I feel lightheaded sometimes." She said "good enough" so I got mine done. No plaque in my case, which is reassuring. But something worth cons..."

r/over60 · 325 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1jyfxh1/carotid_artery_check/

Hearing loss

"I'm 71 and a concert-level pianist. I lost the ability to perform due to a form of rheumatoid arthritis caused by the after effects of chemotherapy, and my life felt pretty crappy. After we moved, my new primary care physician referred me to a hand specialist who specializes in musicians' hands. I've gone through a series of injections (which hurt like bloody hell!) but they unfroze my hand. I also was fitted with good hearing aids since age-related deafness runs in my family. I'm working wit..."

r/Aging · 165 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Aging/comments/1rxbbe2/does_anyone_not_want_to_get_old/ob6s5gb/

"From age 62, the age I retired. Both hips replaced, cataract surgery in both eyes and Non Hodgkin's lymphoma. Had 6 months chemo and 30 days radiation. Lots of side effects and four hospitalizations. Permanent lung damage resulting in severe c.o.p.d, necessitating oxygen 24/7. Sounds pretty bad and it is, but now at 78 I feel better and do more than I did at 60. LIFE is good! I forgot...I have hearing aids as of 8 months ago. They are better than saying "what" all the time. LOL!"

r/AskOldPeople · 146 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/p13apa/living_into_old_age_can_eventually_bring_the_need/h8aqzps/

12. What they refuse, and why

What they refuse	Own voice	Quoted by a child	Accepted	Reasons (own voice)
Assisted living / nursing home	22	52	4	'I'm fine' / not yet 4, Not wanting to be a burden 2, Independence / control 2, To die at home / on my own terms 2
Leaving home (staying put)	51	0	0	Independence / control 10, Home, memories, pets 10, To die at home / on my own terms 7, Cost / money 2
Doctors / medication	3	36	12	
Help in the home (aides, caregivers)	5	30	1	Not wanting to be a burden 2, Cost / money 1, Privacy / strangers / trust 1, Dignity / modesty / treated like a child 1
Help with bathing / personal care	5	23	0	
Hearing aids	1	20	2	
Giving up driving	9	12	0	Pride / feeling old / image 1, Independence / control 1, Privacy / strangers / trust 1, Dignity / modesty / treated like a child 1

Selling the house / downsizing	7	10	0	Home, memories, pets 5, To die at home / on my own terms 2, Cost / money 1
Pre-consent: 'put me in a home if...'	14	0	0	
Walker / cane / wheelchair	2	6	0	
Medical alert / pendant	1	3	0	
Kids handling money / POA	1	2	0	Cost / money 1

Assisted living / nursing home

"I am 94 years old and still live alone . Not in a stick and bricks home but in 28' motorhome that I still drive and move every 2-3 weeks from one campgroun to another. I locate, back into my site, hook up the electric, water and sewer. Then set my jacks, extend my slide out and rearrange the inside from travel mode to stay put mode. I also work on listing jewelry on eBay and make the phone calls on my list of things to take care of. So far I can manage it all but some chores are difficult. One ..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 360 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLGMbc&lc=Ugx6fGhU40zdvpPcx9V4AaABAg>

"I just moved out of a retirement village I lived in for two months and discovered I hate living on somebody else's schedule. Dinner at 4:45? I am 84-old enough to be your mother. Make a move, girl. I bought a house that I plan to live in until I die, hiring help when necessary and sharing life with my caring partner. I figure I'll save a fortune. Those places are enormously expensive, and I was paying for care I didn't need."

YouTube · I Moved to a Retirement Community and Now I Regret It! · 44 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Egdvs0TPrIA&lc=UgyQUGzvc6zeR5-HEhx4AaABAg>

"Mom offended when someone acknowledged her burden on me. During my daily call to my mom she said our relative mentioned that it was sad that I was spending my 'life taking care of old people'. (I'm POA for my mom and another elderly relative.) My mom said she was offended by her cousin's comment and countered that she couldn't be a burden on me because she lives in independent living. She told me..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 309 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n2xzc/mom_offended_when_someone_acknowledged_her_burden/

"My dad doesn't want to live in a nursing home when he gets very old, what should I do? Hi all, my dad is currently 64 and we recently had a stressful conversation about the state of his living when he's older. I'm an only child, and I would ideally love for my parents to live in the same household as I do. In our conversation, I'll be in my late 40s with a family when he turns 90, and I don't thin..."

r/AskOldPeople · as told by their child · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/q4cewj/my_dad_doesnt_want_to_live_in_a_nursing_home_when/

"I would like to say something about long-term care insurance that I have rarely seen mentioned. If you are married and you and your spouse both have LTC insurance, if one of you uses it but dies before it runs out, there can be benefits to the surviving spouse. My husband and I both had LTCI through Genworth (it was costly — about \$7,000 a year for both of us). He was diagnosed with dementia sever..."

r/retirement · spouse carer · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1v5gmkm/how_do_you_all_plan_for_longterm_care/ozzw7s2/

Leaving home (staying put)

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone..

[[https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/)]
([https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i have reached my limit i want to die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/))

First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my po..."

r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i have reached my limit i want to die update shes/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/)

"I am 94 years old and still live alone . Not in a stick and bricks home but in 28' motorhome that I still drive and move every 2-3 weeks from one campgroun to another. I locate, back into my site, hook up the electric, water and sewer. Then set my jacks, extend my slide out and rearrange the inside from travel mode to stay put mode. I also work on listing jewelry on eBay and make the phone calls on my list of things to take care of. So far I can manage it all but some chores are difficult. One ..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 360 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLG-Mbc&lc=Ugx6fGhU40zdvpPcx9V4AaABAq>

Doctors / medication

"This is so scary. I am 79 years old and I live alone. I had breast cancer two years ago, and I faced that because my husband was alive and took me to the doctor and treatments. He is gone now and I am alone. Even my old pets have died. I will not go to the doctor again because I don't want to continue to be around. I'm not that sad because I'm sure of God and rejoining my loved ones. 🙏 . Jesus will call and I will be glad to go."

YouTube · Aging in the U.S. (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMDsUdhymbQ&lc=UgykyIGPMCnw-dkwBoxR4AaABAq>

"I take care of a sister and her husband, she is not actually my sister but the half sister to my half sister. She is in a wheelchair and has had multiple surgeries from breast to brain she has very limited speech as well from the brain surgery, her husband has kidney disease as well as Alzheimer's and dementia. I work 80+ hours a week with four other caregivers round the clock. We are doing everything we can to keep them in their home and the amount of medication prescribed is unbelievable. Per..."

YouTube · Aging in the U.S. (full documentary) | FRONTLINE · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMDsUdhymbQ&lc=UgxvTcnqWLtStcXEPmN4AaABAq.9tL7YKZrEZk9tTsXZ3ftGZ>

""It was ok" Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for the..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 388 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it was ok/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/)

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r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 387 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it was ok/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/)

"In 1982 I was a 24 year old gay guy living it up in Austin Texas. I don't remember the exact moment I first heard about it but it soon became something on everybody's mind. Then people started disappearing, never to be seen again. "Are you going to get tested" was the hot question of the day. I didn't get tested because I was surely infected and there was nothing that could be done about it. By 91..."

r/AskOldPeople · 272 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/13bfcuf/what_were_your_thoughts_on_hiv_and_aids_when_it/jb8mdn/

Help in the home (aides, caregivers)

"Sibling Relationship Problem Question My sister is having open heart surgery next week. I'm 61 and she is 67. I had not heard from her in a few years and she called me a few weeks ago to tell me. I have been very supportive and sent her some gifts, and talked to her on the phone when she calls and have been helping her sort out some things. I told her I would be with her husband at the hospital on the day of surgery. But she is demanding, needy, anxious and has rage and BPD. I love her and wish ..."

r/over60 · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/over60/comments/1w152qc/sibling_relationship_problem_question/

"68 here, in robust health both physically and mentally(at least I think so). First, to answer your questions directly. My children(4) do not take care of my health, and one's wife is a doctor. And I would never expect them to ever take care of my health, I would hire professional helpers if it would become necessary. I could never burden my children with anything like that. I love them too much for that. But secondly, I would like to address your claim of being a hypochondriac. Not that I quest..."

r/AskOldPeople · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/hfdwl3/when_would_you_expect_your_adult_children_to_take/fvxegr8/

"Assisted living NOW. I am done. Looking for perspective and tips.. I've spent the last couple of months trying to figure out how to convince my parents to move to assisted living. Woke up this morning realizing that will never work, and they do not get a choice. Because of my relationship with them, especially my dad, I've been afraid of their reactions and his anger, but thanks to lots of therapy..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 148 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w0y12z/assisted_living_now_i_am_done_looking_for/

"This isn't sustainable and I don't know what to do I live with my 86 year old widowed elderly mother. It's just the two of us; I am 61 and retired. This past week she has had pain from a sciatic nerve. When she is lying down she is fine but sitting, standing, walking is painful. And because of her complex medical issues she can only take Tylenol which, let's be real, doesn't do much. So she shuffl..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 100 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o8zjx8/this_isnt_sustainable_and_i_dont_know_what_to_do/

"When I feel I need to say what I think out loud I talk to my two cats who adoringly sit or lie down and listen I truly believe they understand me, as they often glance at each other in agreement or not agree to what I have said to them, they keep me company and still play me up when they are in a mood to do so. I have hobbies and I rarely talk to a human unless I have to go to do Tors or aOpti..."

YouTube · Things They Don't Tell You About Living Alone as an Older Person · 6 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0zUZA23CtE&lc=Ugy4EQiyag8UfGLuHU4AaABAg_A8HySBS7c86A8mpdbIeQ6R

Help with bathing / personal care

"I am 94 years old and still live alone . Not in a stick and bricks home but in 28' motorhome that I still drive and move every 2-3 weeks from one campgroun to another. I locate, back into my site, hook up the electric, water and sewer. Then set my jacks, extend my slide out and rearrange the inside from travel mode to stay put mode. I also work on listing jewelry on eBay and make the phone calls on my list of things to take care of. So far I can manage it all but some chores are difficult. One ..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 360 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLGMbc&lc=Ugx6fGhU40zdvpPcx9V4AaABAq>

"Thank you for this. I am nearly 83 and my story is almost the same. I refuse to go to a hostel where I will be treated like in a school hostel and forced to shower when I want to bath,like all my life because I can still get in and out without help. I have young people in their 30's around me because my grandson lives,with me! I have a domestic helper who has become my best friend when all the other's died. She sometimes brings her 6 yr old and i take out crayons and paper for her to sit and dra..."

YouTube · I'm 91 years old. If you're afraid to live alone, don't go to a nursing home. Do · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2WzqiXLGMbc&lc=Ugyh3w3bkp0_lrbge7F4AaABAq

"My dad has dementia with aggression and he hates taking a bath. Unfortunately he tends to have bowel incontinence, some days more than once and so we have to bathe him more than once in a day when that happens. Otherwise we try to just wipe him on the days he uses the toilet, but lately he hasn't been using it and just going in his diaper everyday. We try and talk to him nicely but he is quite dis..."

YouTube · Caregiver Training: Refusal to Bathe I UCLA Alzheimer's and Dementia Care · as told by their child · 459 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sl3Dc1kERto&lc=Ugh-KR4-yS5I5XgCoAEC>

"Caring for my mom with dementia has me thinking about my own future. What are you doing to protect your brain health?. My brother (52M) and I (53F) have been caring for our 80-year-old mom, who's declining quickly due to dementia. We're at the point where she refuses meds, won't let us help her bathe or change, and becomes very resistant to even basic care. We've made the difficult decision to mov..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qa1eco/caring_for_my_mom_with_dementia_has_me_thinking/

Hearing aids

"I was born with a neural hearing loss; I am now 64 and have worn hearing aids most of my life. Hearing aids have changed so dramatically from my early school years in the 60's where they amplified everything - ARRRGHH, to early analogue type aids that were not particularly good or clear sounding to the now very clever digital aids. Some early digital aids suffered interference from shop lights, tv signals/displays etc but that is now not the case. I am so used to wearing hearing aids that I don..."

YouTube · Hard To Hear It Episode 5: Wearing my hearing aids vs. not · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7cAhN-5PoMg&lc=UgwY6Hy4wxCUEoxr0cB4AaABAq>

"I'm losing my voice because my mother won't wear her hearing aids. Why won't she wear her hearing aids? Let's start a list. To save money on the batteries. Because they bother her ear. (They are micro hearing aids you can't even see them) Because she doesn't need to wear them all the time; she's in her house. Because they're expensive to replace and she doesn't want to wear them out. So as a r..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 110 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rx4ypb/im_losing_my_voice_because_my_mother_wont_wear/

"My mother did this with her hearing loss. She refused to consider hearing aids because, at 83 with thinning white hair and a hunched over walk, she didn't want people to 'think she was old'. I told her she's not old. I'm old. She's ELDERLY. She got mad but I repeat it every time she says it. So when we are out and she was talking to someone I would announce very loudly "YOU'LL HAVE TO SPEAK UP, SH..."

r/AgingParents · as told by their child · 60 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w86cdk/the_sheer_exhaustion_of_dealing_with_my_dads_pride/p80zv3w/

"Live with my mother-in-law, or, she with us, to be precise. I'm old but still working full time. My partner, her daughter is the full time care giver. Mother-in-law turns 100 later this year. She is a very nice person and easy to cook for. Couple a weeks ago, she finally got hearing aids. They are wonderful."

r/AskOldPeople · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/1u2pkzt/are_any_fellow_old_people_here_caregiving_even/orbe845/

13. Dislikes

Complaint	Documents
Being talked down to, treated as old or invisible	14
Scams and calls that target old people	12
Prices, fees and a fixed income	11
Medicare, insurance and denied coverage	6
Facilities: neglect, food, short staff, the smell	3
Doctors who rush, dismiss or blame age	3
Medical alert contracts, billing and cancelling	3
Children and family who won't listen	2
Hearing aids: price and still not hearing	1
Aides and agencies: late, rude, rotating, stole	0

Being talked down to, treated as old or invisible

"My family is pretending that I am not in early stage dementia. I'm 70 years old and I can feel my mind going. My memory is just terrible but more than that I find myself starting to not understand normal things. The other day I lost my credit card at the gas pump because I put it in slot where the receipts come out, the attendant was quite nice about helping me get my card back and not condescending at all. Another day I was driving along when I ..."

r/dementia · 507 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ks49fe/my_family_is_pretending_that_i_am_not_in_early/

"Honestly, I feel rude saying this but since you are here asking, I think most people my age consider the expectation of a thank-you-note, or any *specific* response, to be tacky. It's basically the same concept as a gift that comes with strings attached, I think? I am actually a person who DOES send thank you notes to people I think would like them and otherwise thank people who help me or give me gifts, but even I agree that "giving" someone som..."

r/AskOldPeople · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/m88mdo/whatever_happened_to_thank_you_notes_or_at_least/grgsZoi/

Scams and calls that target old people

"At one point I thought, "well, I could take these experiences and write a funny book about them..." There are probably 75% scam profiles that come up in my searches. At this point I can recognize them a mile away. There are a group of profiles that have been posting for the past 10 years. I've dated a few of them. Mostly good guys, but some baggage that I just don't want to take on at this point in my life such as: one is chronically unemployed, ..."

r/AskOldPeople · 83 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/oo31u6/divorced_and_widowed_seniors_please_tell_us_your_h5w0997/

"> She would also give us birthday cards with nothing written in them, then ask for them back so she could use them again. My husband and I have a stack of cards (birthdays, anniversaries, Valentine's day etc) that we just continually recycle and give to each other year after year. One of my first jobs was at a drugstore that did a brisk business in Hallmark cards. I quickly figured out what a scam this is. My husband, kids, everyone knows how muc..."

r/AskOldPeople · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/tfkck7/content_or_smug_to_make_do_with_less/i0wndw5/

Prices, fees and a fixed income

"Do you feel disappointed and saddened by the way Christmas is being celebrated? I am an old person myself (67F) living in the US. I am also a grocery cashier. AFAIK, it isn't against the rules of this sub for old people to ask questions of other old people. Christmas was once a religious holiday celebrated by Christians. People decorated their homes, gave gifts to youngsters, donated to the poor, attended church, sang Christmas carols, and got t..."

r/AskOldPeople · 149 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/jo25bi/do_you_feel_disappointed_and_saddened_by_the_way/

"Christmas is what you make of it. I'm not religious, so that aspect doesn't appeal to me, regardless. It is sad that the stress and pressure of the holidays can sometimes bring out the worst in people. I've found that, often times, it brings out all the worst stuff, but because people have the best of intentions. They want to get that special "it" gift for their kids or their significant other and they are feeling the pressure of waiting too lon..."

r/AskOldPeople · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AskOldPeople/comments/jo25bi/do_you_feel_disappointed_and_saddened_by_the_way/gb5fkg/

Medicare, insurance and denied coverage

"Im 74 retired for five years. Everything was going smoothly until the car blew an engine, the upstairs cooling system failed and it cost almost as much to repair as a new system, so we bought the new system. Our granddaughter moved in with us so she could attend the local junior college. One month in, she totaled my pickup and of course insurance doesn't cover the cost of a new one. Money for that. We had it all planned out, we have the house pai..."

r/retirement · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/retirement/comments/1v25nzy/has_anyone_on_here_actually_run_out_of_money/oz7pl8y/

"Elderly widow has to have a 24/7 caregiver but can't afford one. I'm writing this for my 82-year-old neighbor. She has a Medicare supplement plan with UHC. She's in constant pain because she needs a hip replacement, and it's limited her mobility. She can't walk farther than about 100 feet. She doesn't have anyone who could stay with her 24/7 for a week post-op, and because she lives in a tiny apartment, there really isn't room for anyone else, an..."

r/medicare · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/medicare/comments/1u6vh36/elderly_widow_has_to_have_a_247_caregiver_but/

14. Ads addressed to the parent

859 active Meta ads read across 15 quoted phrases: addressed to the parent 91, to parent and child 13, to the adult child 31, neither 658, off-topic 66.

Top performer	Sells	Days	Rank	Opening line
Paiseec	mobility / bathroom safety products	213	#1	Empower your mobility and maintain your independence with PAISEEC's range of mobility scooters and electric wh
EZ Health	Medicare / health plans	67	#1	Want to stay in your home forever? A new Medicare benefit can help you age comfortably in place. Qualify for i
Acorn Stairlifts Inc	mobility / bathroom safety products	88	#2	Regain your independence and access all levels of your home again with a stairlift from Acorn Stairlifts. 0:00
Acorn Stairlifts, Inc.	mobility / bathroom safety products	94	#4	Trust Acorn Stairlifts to renew your independence and regain your mobility on the stairs. 0:00 / 0:18 HTTPS://
Step2bed	fall-prevention and everyday aids (steps, shoes, carts, grips)	328	#5	Help seniors keep their independence with the #1 safety step featured on ABC & NBC. Get in & out of bed while
AARP Member Benefits	long-term care insurance / planning	135	#5	Long-term care helps protect your independence and gives you options for the support you need, when you need i
BioHealth Journal	pain, arthritis and joint devices	269	#7	Tired of Stiff, Aching Hands Every Morning? If arthritis makes opening jars, cooking, or holding your grandchi
EZ Health	Medicare / health plans	67	#7	Want to stay in your home forever? A new Medicare benefit can help you age comfortably in place. Qualify for i
Rolloy-US	mobility / bathroom safety products	248	#9	Say goodbye to bulky walkers! 🚫 Your walker shouldn't take up your space—or your day. Compact, convenient, and
Motus Nova Neuro Recovery	Medicare / health plans	107	#10	Stroke recovery just got easier — and it's covered by Medicare and most private insurance. Motus Nova's FDA-cl

15. Sources, method and gaps

Source	Documents	Parent voice	Quoted by a child
youtube	63,749	2,295	70
reddit_comment	32,195	1,825	91
aarp	6,711	500	2
reddit_post	969	123	26
mayo_connect	680	131	0
study	498	498	0
amazon_browser	220	7	0
trustpilot	176	4	1
youtube (imported)	46	36	10
reddit_post (imported)	45	3	42
reddit_comment (imported)	27	7	20
trustpilot (imported)	14	13	1
agingcare (imported)	10	7	3

amazon_browser (imported)	3	3	0
tiktok (imported)	3	2	1
google_review (imported)	2	2	0
caring_com (imported)	2	2	0

Precision reads

- YouTube parent voice: 19 of 20 random documents were the older adult speaking (gate v3, seed 2026).
- AARP community parent voice: about 9 of 10 random documents.
- Condition subreddits parent voice: about 10 of 12; older-adult subreddits about 9 of 12, before the young-widow and young-parent fixes.
- Children quoting the parent: 16 of 18 on YouTube, about 11 of 12 in Reddit caregiver subreddits, about 12 of 16 in the refusal queue.
- r/AskOldPeople: the first venue rule counted 3,310 comments on venue alone; a random read found about 5 of 16 were a parent speaking about their own aging, so the rule now requires an own-aging, body or retirement marker.
- A romance-scam 'widower' comment pasted 47 times by two accounts surfaced in the vocabulary ledger; a near-duplicate filter now flags 488 documents, which never reach a count or a quote.
- Theme precision: the frame and the subject must sit in the same sentence; an earlier neighbour-sentence window let 'driving me crazy' and 'a burden lifted off my shoulders' in, and was removed.

Not pulled, and why

- Mayo Clinic Connect showed a human-verification page after a fast crawl; a polite single-reader crawl ran at about 15 minutes a discussion, so only a small share of the 377 Aging Well discussions is in the corpus.
- SeniorForums.com: Cloudflare blocked both research browsers; not pulled.
- Quora and Facebook groups for older adults: not pulled in this run.
- TrustPilot: the 4 brands the parents name; most reviews do not say who wrote them, so only a handful are confirmed as written by the older adult.
- Amazon: the top reviews shown without login for each product; the full review pages require login.
- Condition subreddits (Parkinson's, stroke, macular degeneration and others) were pulled but rarely state an age, so few of their posts count as parent voice.

Tool status

- 2026-09-13: Apify, all nine accounts at their monthly cap (earliest reset 2026-09-19); SerpAPI 0 of 250 searches left; Tavily 52 of 1,000 credits left.
- Used instead: the logged-in research Chrome (Reddit), a second headful Chrome (Mayo Clinic Connect), headless Chromium (AARP community, Meta Ad Library, TrustPilot, Amazon), the YouTube Data API, and PubMed Central E-utilities for the qualitative studies.